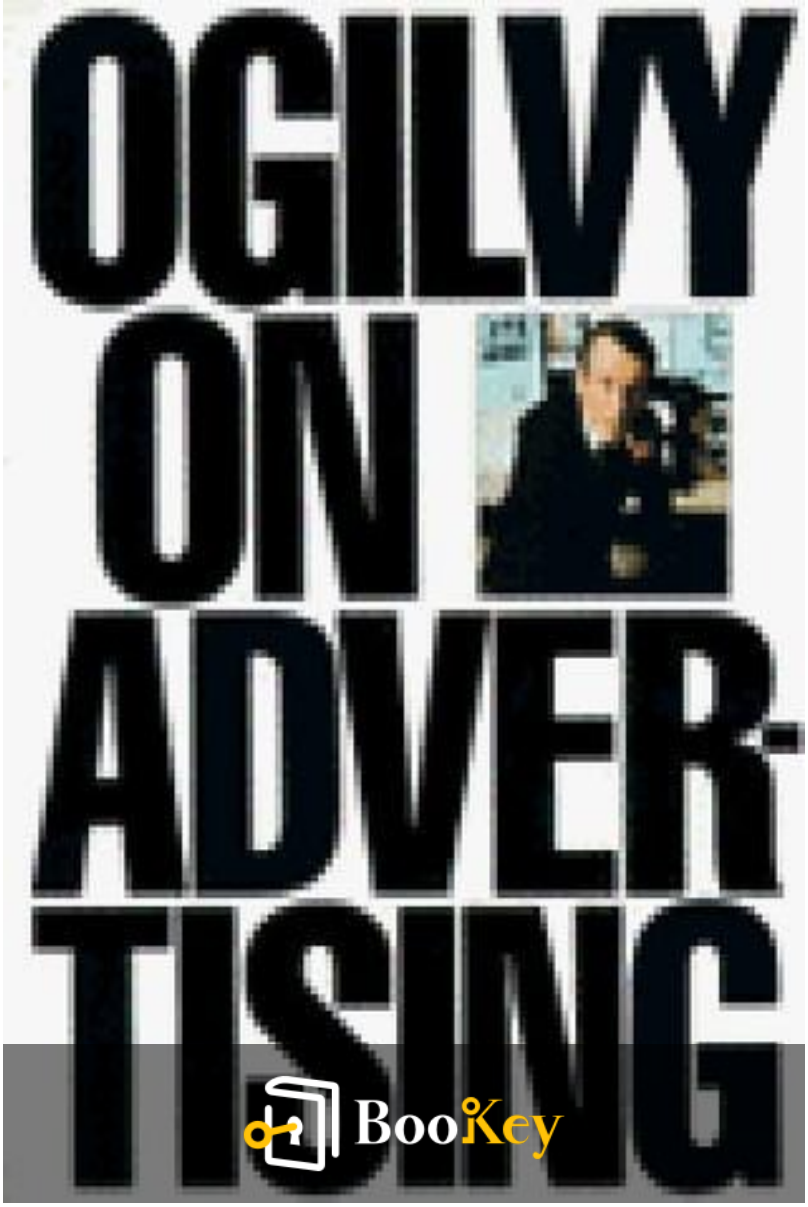
Ogilvy on Advertising PDF

David Ogilvy



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Ogilvy on Advertising

Essential insights from the master of modern advertising.

Written by Bookey

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About the book

In "Ogilvy on Advertising," David Ogilvy, a renowned figure in the advertising world, shares his invaluable insights and experiences in an engaging and straightforward manner. This essential guide covers a wide array of topics, including how to land a job in advertising, select the right agency for your brand, and craft compelling copy that captures attention. Ogilvy reveals the secrets behind successful campaigns, presents groundbreaking research findings, and explores the impactful role of advertising for charitable organizations. With his signature blend of honesty and generosity, Ogilvy offers readers a treasure trove of knowledge for thriving in the competitive advertising landscape.

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About the author

David Mackenzie Ogilvy, born on June 23, 1911, in West Horsley, England, was a pioneering figure in the advertising world. Educated at Fettes College and Christ Church, Oxford, he never completed his degree but embarked on a diverse career that began with an unconventional stint in the kitchen of the Hotel Majestic in Paris. There, he cultivated invaluable skills in discipline and management, realizing the importance of timing in career choices. Upon returning to England, Ogilvy excelled in door-to-door sales for Aga Cookers, earning acclaim for his exceptional sales manual, deemed by Fortune magazine as "probably the best sales manual ever written." His innovative strategies emphasized the balance of quality and quantity in sales. In 1938, he emigrated to the United States and joined George Gallup's Audience Research Institute, where he adopted rigorous research methodologies that would shape his future work. Ogilvy's contributions to advertising are foundational, drawing from his rich experiences and insights in human behavior and consumer psychology.

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Summary Content List

Chapter 1 : 1. Overture

Chapter 2 : 2. How to produce advertising that sells

Chapter 3 : 3. Jobs in advertising – and how to get them

Chapter 4 : 4. How to run an advertising agency

Chapter 5 : 5. How to get clients

Chapter 6 : 6. Open letter to a client in search of an agency

Chapter 7 : 7. Wanted: a renaissance in print advertising

Chapter 8 : 8. How to make TV commercials that sell

Chapter 9 : 9. Advertising corporations

Chapter 10 : 10. How to advertise foreign travel

Chapter 11 : 11. The secrets of success in business-to-business advertising

Chapter 12 : 12. Direct mail, my first love and secret weapon

Chapter 13 : 13. Advertising for good causes

Chapter 14 : 14. Competing with Procter & Gamble

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Chapter 15 : 15. 18 Miracles of research

Chapter 16 : 16. What little I know about marketing

Chapter 17 : 17. Is America still top nation?

Chapter 18 : 18. Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins and Bernbach

Chapter 19 : 19. What’s wrong with advertising?

Chapter 20 : 20. I predict 13 changes

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Chapter 1 Summary : 1. Overture

Overture

Perspective on Advertising

David Ogilvy emphasizes that advertising is primarily a medium of information rather than an artistic endeavor. His goal in writing advertisements is to engage customers to the point of making a purchase, rather than merely being recognized for creativity.

The Evolution of Ogilvy & Mather

He reflects on the evolution of his agency, which started as a

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small creative firm in 1949 and grew into one of the largest advertising agencies globally. Despite changes in the advertising landscape, he believes many fundamental principles remain valid.

Changes in Advertising Landscape

Ogilvy acknowledges that television is the most significant change in advertising since his early days but argues that many previously effective techniques continue to yield results today. He critiques trendy notions that old techniques are obsolete, citing that effective advertising still appeals to consumer desires like value and social status.

Critique of Advertising Trends

He expresses disdain for the loud and eccentric voices in advertising that criticize established techniques without acknowledging their proven effectiveness. Ogilvy positions himself as a sales-driven practitioner, having achieved significant sales results compared to the more avant-garde campaigns that may do well socially but lack effectiveness in sales.

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Research-Driven Approach

Ogilvy insists that his insights are based on consumer response and research rather than restrictive rules. He illustrates this point by discussing how empirical evidence can guide decisions in advertising strategy.

Aim of the Book

This book is intended for those eager to learn about advertising, including both novices and seasoned professionals seeking to enhance their effectiveness. Ogilvy shares knowledge gained from his personal experience and does not cover all advertising topics, focusing instead on what he knows best.

Collaboration and Improvement

He acknowledges contributions from his partners in refining his work, showing a willingness to accept help and improve through collaboration.

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Chapter 2 Summary : 2. How to produce advertising that sells

Section	Summary
Introduction	David Ogilvy emphasizes the need for careful research and strategic execution to create effective advertising, highlighting that small changes can lead to significant differences in sales.
The Importance of Homework	Successful advertising relies on thorough understanding of the product and market to resonate with buyers.
Positioning	Positioning defines product perception in the market, focusing on unique attributes that align with consumer needs.
Brand Image	A strong and consistent brand image influences consumer preferences, often more than product features.
Big Ideas	Effective advertising is driven by "big ideas," which require a creative process that allows innovative thoughts to flourish.
Simplicity and Product Focus	Advertising should simplify messages and put the product at the forefront, favoring straightforward communications.
Positively Good	Brands should aim to be seen as "positively good" through honest communication of benefits rather than superior to competitors.
Repeated Success	Successful ads should be repeated for effectiveness, as research indicates repetition can attract new consumers without diminishing readership.
Word of Mouth	Creating memorable ads can spur word-of-mouth promotion, embedding campaigns into popular culture.
Avoiding Committee Work	Ogilvy cautions against committee-driven campaigns that dilute messages, advocating for strong, creative ideas to remain untainted by excessive feedback.
Ambition and Learning	Advertising professionals should be ambitious and eager to learn, gaining insights from past campaigns to improve their work.
Addressing Creativity	Creativity should focus on achieving sales results rather than purely artistic expression, prioritizing functionality.
On the Use of Sex	Sexual imagery must be relevant to the product; Ogilvy promotes tasteful use of sensual themes in line

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Section	Summary
in Advertising	with societal norms.
Conclusion	By following principles like thorough research, effective positioning, strong branding, and clarity, advertisers can create compelling campaigns.

How to Produce Advertising That Sells

Introduction

In this chapter, David Ogilvy emphasizes the importance of producing effective advertising through careful research and strategic execution. Advertising can vary significantly in its effectiveness, with even minor changes leading to drastic differences in sales.

The Importance of Homework

Successful advertising begins with thorough homework about the product and the market. Understanding the product's features and consumer perceptions can lead to compelling advertising that resonates with potential buyers.

Positioning

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Positioning defines how a product is perceived in the market. By identifying unique attributes and aligning them with target consumer needs, marketers can create effective and enduring campaigns.

Brand Image

A strong brand image is essential for product identity. Consistent messaging and a positive image influence consumer perceptions and preferences. Quality and aspirational branding often drive consumer choices more than product features alone.

Big Ideas

Ogilvy stresses that effective advertising requires "big ideas." These are not easily generated; the creative process involves informing the mind and allowing subconscious thoughts to flow freely to generate innovative concepts that can endure over time.

Simplicity and Product Focus

Ads should simplify the product message and make the

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product the hero. Consumers respond better to straightforward, product-centric messages rather than flashy or convoluted campaigns.

Positively Good

Instead of positioning products as superior to competitors, brands should focus on being seen as "positively good." This can be achieved through clear, honest communication of product benefits.

Repeated Success

Successful ads should be repeated until they lose effectiveness. Research indicates that repeated exposure does not diminish readership and can continually attract new consumers.

Word of Mouth

Effective advertising can become part of popular culture, generating word-of-mouth promotion. Creating memorable campaigns can lead to spontaneous consumer conversations.

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Avoiding Committee Work

Ogilvy warns against the pitfalls of committee-driven campaigns, which often result in diluted messages. Strong, creative ideas should not be bogged down by excessive input and critiques from multiple sources.

Ambition and Learning

Advertising professionals should possess ambition and a desire for knowledge to elevate their craft. Learning from past campaigns and direct response advertising techniques can yield valuable insights for success.

Addressing Creativity

While creativity is important, Ogilvy suggests focusing on sales results over artistic expression. Effective advertising should prioritize functionality and results over mere creativity.

On the Use of Sex in Advertising

Sexual imagery should always be relevant to the product.

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Ogilvy advocates for tasteful and relevant use of sensual themes, insisting that advertising should reflect societal norms without being overtly provocative.

Conclusion

By adhering to these principles—conducting thorough research, positioning products effectively, building a strong brand image, creating big ideas, and ensuring clarity and relevance—advertisers can produce compelling and successful campaigns.

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Example

Key Point:Understanding the importance of thorough research and market positioning is crucial for impactful advertising.

Example:Imagine you're launching a new organic shampoo. You dive deep into research, discovering potential customers desire eco-friendly products due to their health and environmental concerns. By emphasizing your shampoo’s natural ingredients and benefits while aligning it with the consumers' values about sustainability, your advertisements resonate strongly. This powerful positioning not only clarifies what makes your product unique, but it also connects emotionally with your target audience, leading to higher sales and brand loyalty.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The emphasis on research and positioning in effective advertising

Critical Interpretation:Ogilvy argues that thorough research and strategic product positioning are crucial for crafting successful advertising campaigns. However, while this perspective highlights the importance of understanding the consumer and market dynamics, it overlooks the influence of emotional and psychological factors that can drive purchasing decisions. Research by psychologists like Daniel Kahneman suggests that consumer choices are often not based entirely on rational assessment but are also swayed by cognitive biases and emotions (Kahneman, 2011). As such, Ogilvy's approach, while grounded in practical marketing principles, may need to account for the complexities of human behavior beyond solid research and positioning.

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Chapter 3 Summary : 3. Jobs in advertising – and how to get them

Section	Summary
Career Paths in Advertising	Includes media roles selling ad space, retail advertising, brand management in manufacturing, and diverse roles within advertising agencies.
Copywriters	Must possess traits like curiosity and writing skills; categorized as poets (art-focused) or killers (effectiveness-focused).
Art Directors	Need training in film, layout, and typography; can advance to Creative Director roles with experience.
Account Executives	Coordinate agency efforts and client relations; background in brand management is helpful; increasing female representation.
Researchers	Typically possess degrees in statistics or psychology; face challenges with turnaround times and methodology consensus.
Media Specialists	Require analytical skills and negotiation capabilities with media owners.
Chief Executive Officer	Involves leadership and financial skills; highly stressful role.
Creative Director	Needs psychological insight, high standards, strategic thinking, and strong communication abilities.
Women in Advertising	Increasing representation in higher roles; facing resistance to feminist language changes.
Firing and Hiring Trends	High turnover rates are now common; recruiting practices can be lacking.
Education for Advertising	Agencies prefer candidates with liberal arts backgrounds despite available advertising courses at universities.
Social Status and Public Perception	Advertising may be viewed negatively in some cultures but many find satisfaction in their careers.
Moonlighting	Taking on additional outside work is common to supplement income.
How to Apply for a Job	Submit a CV and cover letter stating position and qualifications; suggest interview times for employer convenience.
Final Thoughts	A career in advertising requires interest and dedication, offering diverse roles and competitive pay, but not guaranteed wealth.

Jobs in Advertising – And How to Get Them

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Career Paths in Advertising

-

Media Roles:

Work with networks, stations, magazines, or newspapers to sell advertising space.

-

Retail Advertising:

Join a retailer as a copywriter, art director, or advertising manager.

-

Brand Management:

Work in manufacturing companies, focusing on brand management.

-

Advertising Agencies:

Opportunities in agencies offer diverse roles and stimulating

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Chapter 4 Summary : 4. How to run an advertising agency

Section	Summary
Overview of Agency Operations	Running an advertising agency requires hard work and resilience, dealing with high stress and continuous anxiety.
Creating a Positive Work Environment	Leaders should create a fun atmosphere, encouraging open communication and eliminating negativity to boost creativity.
Characteristics of Successful Agency Leaders	Successful leaders are enthusiastic, honest, resilient, charming, and possess strong communication skills.
The Nature of Agency Work	Most agency employees perform roles other than creating advertisements, such as research and media planning.
Hiring Practices for Success	Agencies should focus on hiring talented individuals with leadership potential, avoiding nepotism.
Promoting Internal Talent	Nurturing leadership from within while also seeking external talent can strengthen the agency.
Avoiding Hiring Pitfalls	Leaders should avoid hiring friends and relatives to prevent complications in workplace dynamics.
Handling Office Politics	Leaders should discourage office politics to foster collaboration and teamwork.
Maintaining Professional Standards	Enforcing discipline around punctuality and performance standards is crucial for success.
The Importance of Leadership	Effective leadership involves inspiring others and fulfilling their psychological needs while promoting innovation.
Alcoholism in the Workplace	Compassionately addressing alcoholism can help retain valuable employees and maintain performance.
Establishing Written Principles	A set of written principles helps guide management, prioritizing client service over profit.
Profit Management	Agencies must balance profit management cautiously for long-term sustainability.
Compensation Structures	Choosing a fee system over commission allows for clearer accountability and fairer profits.
Profit Utilization Strategies	Profits should be invested wisely to stabilize the agency, avoiding risky ventures.
Tips for Effective Agency Management	Consolidate roles, engage staff informally, prioritize verbal communication, use client products, and refrain from complaint letters for better management.

How to Run an Advertising Agency

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Overview of Agency Operations

Running an advertising agency demands hard work, resilience, and strong leadership to maintain morale in a high-stress environment. Agencies often endure continuous anxiety, whether through the pressure faced by copywriters, account executives, or agency heads.

Creating a Positive Work Environment

To foster creativity and productivity, agency leaders should cultivate a fun and exuberant atmosphere. Encouraging open communication and eliminating negativity are essential for success.

Characteristics of Successful Agency Leaders

Leaders in advertising agencies should possess enthusiasm, intellectual honesty, resilience, and the charm to inspire others. Effective communication and good listening skills are also critical traits.

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The Nature of Agency Work

Contrary to popular belief, not all agency employees create advertisements. A majority handle research, media planning, and clerical tasks, highlighting the importance of managing diverse roles and relationships among employees.

Hiring Practices for Success

Successful agency management hinges on hiring exceptional talent. Ideal candidates exhibit curiosity, humor, and a dedication to advertising. It's critical to avoid nepotism and to focus on individuals with a proven track record of leadership potential.

Promoting Internal Talent

Great agencies recognize and nurture leadership potential from within while also seeking external talent to infuse freshness and diversity. Balancing both approaches can enhance agency strength.

Avoiding Hiring Pitfalls

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Agency heads should avoid hiring friends, relatives, or clients' children to prevent complications arising from personal relationships.

Handling Office Politics

Agency environments can lead to office politics and rivalry. Leaders should actively discourage such behavior to maintain focus on collaboration and teamwork.

Maintaining Professional Standards

Discipline is crucial in an advertising agency. Leaders should enforce punctuality, respect for client confidentiality, and high performance standards to drive success.

The Importance of Leadership

Effective leadership is more than problem-solving; it involves inspiring followers and understanding their psychological needs. Adaptable leaders are often unconventional thinkers who promote innovation.

Alcoholism in the Workplace

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Alcoholism affects many executives, impacting their performance. Addressing it compassionately can salvage valuable employees.

Establishing Written Principles

Developing a written set of principles can guide agency management effectively. Prioritizing client service over profits can lead to lasting success.

Profit Management

Agencies face a delicate balance in managing profits and costs. Sustainable practices often yield better long-term results than aggressive cost-cutting.

Compensation Structures

Leaders may choose between commission and fee systems for compensating agency services. The fee system allows for clearer accountability and potential for fairer profits.

Profit Utilization Strategies

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Investing profits wisely—such as expanding offices or building reserves—can stabilize an agency's financial standing. Caution is advised against risky ventures and acquisitions.

Tips for Effective Agency Management

1. Consolidate roles to avoid redundancy.
2. Engage staff informally to reduce intimidation.
3. Prioritize verbal communication for effective decision-making.
4. Use client products to demonstrate commitment.
5. Refrain from writing complaint letters to maintain professional relationships.

By adhering to these guidelines, agency leaders can foster a productive, innovative, and enjoyable work environment, bolstering both employee morale and client satisfaction.

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Example

Key Point:Fostering a Positive Work Environment is Crucial for Success

Example:Imagine walking into your agency each day where laughter echoes through the halls, creativity flows like a river, and every team meeting feels like a collaborative celebration. This vibrant atmosphere, cultivated through open communication and positivity, empowers you and your colleagues to brainstorm innovative ideas without the stifling fear of negativity. Leaders who prioritize this joyful environment not only boost morale but also ignite enthusiasm in everyone, ultimately driving the agency's success through better teamwork and exceptional client service.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Importance of Leadership in Advertising Agencies

Critical Interpretation:David Ogilvy underscores that strong leadership is vital for success in advertising agencies, highlighting that leaders must inspire and motivate their teams. However, while Ogilvy asserts that unconventional thinking drives innovation, it's crucial to consider research indicating that effective leadership also varies significantly across different organizational cultures. For example, in their study "The Leadership Challenge," Kouzes and Posner (2017) emphasize the importance of adaptable styles that resonate with specific employee needs rather than a one-size-fits-all approach. Thus, Ogilvy’s perspective, while enlightening, may overlook the nuanced nature of leadership suited to diverse workplace dynamics.

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Chapter 5 Summary : 5. How to get clients

Section	Summary
Introduction	David Ogilvy shares his successful methods for acquiring clients, highlighting the importance of good advertising.
Starting Out	Initially, Ogilvy targeted desirable clients like General Foods and IBM, leading to significant billings, despite taking any available accounts early on.
The Importance of Good Advertising	Exceptional advertising work is key to acquiring clients; showcasing past successes is more effective than lengthy questionnaires.
Presentation Strategies	Casual seating arrangements during client meetings foster collaboration, while listening and transparency build credibility.
Avoiding Pitfalls	Taking on new clients is risky; Ogilvy advises caution regarding credit and client compatibility, sharing experiences of turning down unsuitable accounts.
Multinational Accounts	Securing multinational accounts can expand global opportunities, as seen in Ogilvy's work with Shell, though competition exists from local agencies.
Agency Reputation and Growth	Agencies must be aware of their reputation and seek feedback to identify weaknesses, and a versatile portfolio is essential for growth.
Big vs. Small Agencies	Larger agencies face bureaucracy and less personalized service; small agencies can thrive with creativity and attention, often handling many smaller accounts.
Advertising the Agency	Ogilvy points out the irony that agencies often neglect their own marketing, stressing the need for consistency and clarity in messaging.
Conclusion	Creativity, strategic marketing, and careful client selection are essential for a successful advertising agency, according to Ogilvy’s insights.

How to Get Clients

Introduction

David Ogilvy reflects on his successful experience in

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acquiring clients for his advertising agency, Ogilvy & Mather, emphasizing that good advertising is the key to attracting new clients.

Starting Out

- Ogilvy’s initial strategy involved targeting desired clients, which eventually led to major accounts like General Foods and IBM, resulting in over three billion dollars in billings.
- Early in his career, necessity forced him to take any available accounts, but he soon secured high-profile clients that highlighted his agency's capabilities.

The Importance of Good Advertising

- Ogilvy believes the best way to gain clients is to produce exceptional advertising work.
- Success in new business pitches is often achieved by showcasing past campaigns rather than engaging in lengthy processes like answering questionnaires.

Presentation Strategies

- For client meetings, Ogilvy recommends a casual seating

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arrangement to foster collaboration.
- He emphasizes the importance of listening to clients and being genuine about weaknesses to build credibility.

Avoiding Pitfalls

- Taking on new clients can be risky; Ogilvy advises caution regarding credit risks and incompatible clients.
- He recounts personal experiences of turning down accounts that did not align with his agency's ethos.

Multinational Accounts

- Securing multinational accounts can open doors globally, as showcased by Ogilvy's experience with Shell.
- The competitive landscape includes local agencies, but effective adaptation can lead to success in foreign markets.

Agency Reputation and Growth

- Agencies should be aware of their standing in the marketing community and seek external feedback to identify weak points.
- Building a robust portfolio requires versatility in

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advertising styles and a diverse skill set among staff.

Big vs. Small Agencies

- Larger agencies struggle with bureaucracy and may lack personalized service, while small agencies often can deliver creativity and attention.
- Both can coexist; small agencies may find success among numerous small accounts.

Advertising the Agency

- Ogilvy highlights the irony that advertising agencies often neglect to market themselves effectively.
- Consistency and clarity in messaging are crucial for house advertisements, which should resonate with prospective clients rather than impress peers.

Conclusion

Ogilvy’s insights underline the value of creativity, strategic marketing, and careful client selection in building a successful advertising agency.

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Example

Key Point:The power of showcasing past successful campaigns to attract new clients.

Example:Imagine you walk into a potential client's office for a pitch. Instead of relying on lengthy documents or a robot-like presentation, you present a vibrant portfolio filled with captivating advertisements that your agency has crafted. Each campaign tells a story of creativity and impact, demonstrating how your work has driven brand success. As you point to an ad that transformed a struggling product into a bestseller, the client's eyes light up with interest and excitement, leaning forward for more. This scenario exemplifies how powerful showcasing your past achievements can be in attracting new clients and forging valuable partnerships.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Role of Good Advertising in Client Acquisition

Critical Interpretation:David Ogilvy's assertion that 'good advertising is the key to attracting new clients' invites scrutiny, as it suggests a direct correlation between advertising quality and client acquisition. While Ogilvy's successes support this notion, critics may argue that such a deterministic view overlooks other critical factors, such as market conditions, client relationships, and economic variables, which can significantly influence client decisions. Not all companies find success solely through their advertising efforts; even brilliant campaigns can fail due to poor product-market fit or industry disruption. Research, such as that by Philip Kotler in 'Marketing Management,' emphasizes that effective marketing encompasses a broader strategy beyond creative advertising. Therefore, readers should consider that while Ogilvy’s experiences provide valuable lessons, they reflect a particular context that may not universally apply, demanding a nuanced understanding of client acquisition in the complex landscape of advertising.

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Chapter 6 Summary : 6. Open letter to a client in search of an agency

Open Letter to a Client in Search of an Agency

Introduction

Choose your agency carefully without delegating the selection process to a committee. Personal involvement is crucial.

Selecting an Agency

1.
Research
: Look through magazines and watch TV for ads you admire. Identify the agencies behind them.
2.
Competitor Check
: Verify which agencies are already working with your competitors.

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3.
Meet Agency Heads
: Conduct meetings with the heads and Creative Directors of shortlisted agencies to assess chemistry.
4.
Evaluation of Work
: Request to see each agency's best ads to determine the quality of their campaigns.
5.
Compensation Structure
: Agree on a fair compensation—pay a bit more for better service, and avoid haggling.

Long-term Partnership

- Insist on a five-year contract to foster stability and discourage competitors from poaching your agency.

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Chapter 7 Summary : 7. Wanted: a renaissance in print advertising

Wanted: a Renaissance in Print Advertising

Overview

In this chapter, David Ogilvy emphasizes the importance of print advertising, contrasting it with the excitement of television commercials. He highlights a lack of expertise in creating effective print ads, particularly in certain industries like food and cigarettes, and urges advertisers to adopt proven formulae for success.

Headlines

-
Key Importance
: Headlines significantly influence ad performance, with five times more readers versus body copy. A strong headline can effectively sell products.

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-

Effective Strategies

: Headlines promising benefits, containing news, and specifying information boost recall. Including the brand name is crucial, as most readers skip body copy.

-

Length and Specificity

: Long headlines can sell more, but specificity is essential. Accurate figures are more credible than vague statements.

-

Avoid Misleading Techniques

: Complicated or vague headlines, including puns, are less effective. A clear and direct approach is necessary.

Illustrations

-

Impact of Visuals

: Compelling photographs engage curiosity and drive interest. Before-and-after visuals can significantly increase sales.

-

Simplicity in Design

: Simple, focused illustrations with a narrative element

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capture attention, while overcrowded or irrelevant images detract from the ad’s effectiveness.

Body Copy

-
Reader Engagement
: While often overlooked, body copy can attract readers if intriguing and well-targeted. It should communicate benefits directly to the consumer.
-
Personal Touch
: Writing in a conversational tone and avoiding complex language enhances readability.
-
Testimonials
: Including testimonials increases credibility, though celebrity endorsements may distract from the product.

Layouts

-
Effective Structure
: Ads should prioritize illustration, headline, and body copy

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in that order. Maintaining a simple layout boosts engagement.

-

Editorial Style

: Ads resembling editorials attract more readership, as people are accustomed to reading articles.

Typography

-

Importance of Readability

: Good typography enhances comprehension, while improper formatting can hinder reading. Capital letters and reverse type can reduce engagement.

-

Design Techniques

: Simple fixes like drop-initials, spacing adjustments, and clear paragraphing can improve readability.

Conclusion

Ogilvy advocates for a return to thoughtful, strategic print advertising that values consumer engagement and clarity over trendy designs. He emphasizes that attention to detail is

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crucial for effective advertising outcomes, drawing parallels to architecture with the aphorism, "God is in the details."

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Example

Key Point:The Power of a Great Headline

Example:Imagine walking through a magazine aisle and spotting a headline that instantly grabs your attention, promising the solution to a problem you've been struggling with. This headline not just captures your curiosity but compels you to pause and read more, highlighting the pivotal role that a strong headline plays in print advertising. Engaging headlines resonate with your interests, often resulting in immediate action, such as purchasing the product or seeking further information, illustrating why investing time into crafting the perfect headline is essential for any successful advertisement.

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Chapter 8 Summary : 8. How to make TV commercials that sell

Chapter 8: How to Make TV Commercials That Sell

In this chapter, David Ogilvy discusses the effective creation of television commercials, drawing on research and personal experiences in advertising. He highlights the challenge of conveying commercials through text and primarily relies on research conclusions rather than his limited personal experience with television advertising.

Research Insights

- Celebrity testimonials, while popular, often fail to shift brand preferences.
- Changes in brand preference measured by research are more closely related to purchase behavior than recall scores, prompting Ogilvy to focus on the former.

Effective Types of Commercials

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1.

Humor

: Recent research shows humor can effectively sell products, contrasting past beliefs.

2.

Slice of Life

: Shows real-life scenarios where a product resolves conflicts, leading to successful sales.

3.

Testimonials

: Authentic testimonials from loyal users are more persuasive when done naturally.

4.

Demonstrations

: Visual proof of product performance enhances credibility.

5.

Problem-Solution

: Presenting a relatable problem followed by the product as a solution is an effective strategy.

6.

Talking Heads

: Pitchers presenting products directly can shift brand preference, especially for new products.

7.

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Characters
: Memorable characters over time can create strong associations with a product.
8.
Reason Why
: Providing logical reasons for purchasing can slightly improve effectiveness.
9.
News
: New product announcements can capture interest, while established products benefit from innovative usages.
10.
Emotion
: Content that evokes nostalgia and sentiment can be powerful in promoting products.

Ineffective Types of Commercials

1.
Celebrity Testimonials
: Often lead to brand forgetfulness due to the focus on the celebrity rather than the product.
2.
Cartoons

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: More effective for children and less persuasive for adults.
3.
Musical Vignettes
: Generally ineffective due to their focus on entertainment over sales.

Sixteen Practical Tips for Effective Commercials

1. Brand identification must be clear and repeated early.
2. Show the product package at the end.
3. Make food appealing through motion.
4. Use close-ups to highlight products.
5. Begin with an attention-grabbing image.
6. Avoid jingles, but use music judiciously.
7. Use effective sound effects.
8. Prefer on-camera presentations over voice-overs.
9. Reinforce spoken promises with visual text.
10. Avoid visual clichés and mundane imagery.
11. Limit rapid scene changes.
12. Use mnemonics for brand reinforcement.
13. Show the product in use with visible results.
14. Emphasize creativity and imagination in execution.
15. Ensure clarity to avoid miscomprehension.
16. Recognize the high cost of TV commercials and the

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importance of budget management.

Radio Advertising Insights

Ogilvy addresses the decline of radio as an advertising medium, suggesting that commercials must grab attention and engage listeners, as they often serve as background noise. Key strategies for effective radio ads include early brand identification and promises of benefits.
In summary, Ogilvy emphasizes the importance of creativity and strategic thinking in both television and radio advertising to effectively promote products and engage consumers.

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Example

Key Point:Utilize humor strategically in commercials for increased consumer engagement.

Example:Imagine you're watching late-night television after a long day; a commercial suddenly breaks in, using sharp wit and relatable humor that makes you chuckle. Rather than feeling like an interruption, it draws you in, making you more likely to remember the product being sold—unlike the typical, dull advertisements you often tune out.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The challenge of celebrity endorsements in advertising.

Critical Interpretation:Ogilvy suggests that celebrity testimonials fail to significantly influence brand preferences, a claim that invites scrutiny. While he presents research to support this standpoint, the effectiveness of celebrity endorsements can vary greatly based on context, target audience, and even the celebrity's alignment with the brand values. For example, a study in the Journal of Advertising Research emphasizes that when a celebrity resonates well with the product's target demographic, their endorsements can enhance consumer perception and drive purchases (T. A. T. S. Ewens, 'Celebrity Endorsements: Factors Influencing Effectiveness'). Thus, Ogilvy's generalization may overlook specific instances where celebrity power is beneficial.

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Chapter 9 Summary : 9. Advertising corporations

Corporate Advertising

Introduction to Corporate Advertising

Corporate advertising aims to promote the corporation itself rather than just its products. Many large corporations invest heavily in corporate advertising, yet many fail to execute effective campaigns.

Importance and Benefits of Corporate Advertising

- Corporate advertising can significantly improve public perception and employee morale.
- It aids in attracting talent and can positively influence stock prices; studies show an average increase of 2% in stock pricing.
- Long-term commitment is essential, as many campaigns do not reach their objectives due to premature termination.

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Common Failures in Corporate Advertising

- Campaigns often lack clear objectives and fail to utilize research.
- Many companies view corporate advertising as unnecessary compared to product advertising.
- The language used in corporate advertisements tends to be generic and unappealing, which leads to poor engagement from audiences.

Examples of Ineffective Messaging

- Many corporate slogans are interchangeable and filled with verbose language, which fails to capture attention or differentiate the brand.

Funding and Strategy Issues

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The Concept

BOOKS FOR AFRICA × ×

This book donation activity is rolling out together with Books For Africa. We release this project because we share the same belief as BFA: For many children in Africa, the gift of books truly is a gift of hope.

The Rule

Earn 100 points → **Redeem a book** → **Donate to Africa**

Your learning not only brings knowledge but also allows you to earn points for charitable causes! For every 100 points you earn, a book will be donated to Africa.

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Chapter 10 Summary : 10. How to advertise foreign travel

How to Advertise Foreign Travel

Introduction to Travel Advertising

David Ogilvy shares insights from his extensive experience in advertising foreign travel for destinations like Britain, France, the United States, and Puerto Rico, as well as for various travel carriers and financial services supporting tourism.

Understanding Audience Preferences

Ogilvy emphasizes the importance of research in travel advertising. For example, American tourists prefer historical sights in Britain. Despite criticism from the British press for showcasing traditional aspects, this targeted approach led to Britain becoming the top destination for American tourists.

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Complexities of Advertising

He discusses challenges such as governmental demands and perceptions of countries, like the requirement to feature economically depressed areas in Britain for tourism ads or the push to highlight less popular regions of the United States.

Budget Constraints in Tourism Advertising

Many countries allocate insufficient funds for tourism advertising, leading to missed opportunities in attracting foreign tourists. Notable exceptions include nations like Canada and some Caribbean islands, which effectively promote tourism.

Changing Perceptions

Ogilvy illustrates the process of changing negative images associated with destinations. Advertising Puerto Rico effectively transformed its perception from dirty and squalid to beautiful and appealing.

Unique and Relevant Content

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The best tourism advertising highlights unique elements of a country. Effective campaigns showcase attractions that cannot be replicated elsewhere, ensuring relevance to potential tourists.

Combating Fears and Misconceptions

Addressing American tourists' fears—such as concerns about communication or dangers associated with foreign travel—is critical. Tourism ads should aim to alleviate these fears by providing relatable information.

Fashion in Travel Patterns

Travel destinations often experience trends; thus, advertising needs to adapt to changing patterns of popularity.

Medium of Advertising

While print media has its benefits, Ogilvy argues that television can be an even more effective platform for tourism advertising, citing successful campaigns that evoke charm and differentiation.

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Conclusion

Ultimately, effective travel advertising combines appealing visuals with detailed practical information, helping to turn dreams of foreign travel into reality.

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Chapter 11 Summary : 11. The secrets of success in business-to-business advertising

11 The Secrets of Success in Business-to-Business Advertising

Overview of Business-to-Business Advertising

Business-to-business (B2B) advertising, previously known as trade or industrial advertising, aims to promote products purchased for company use rather than individual consumption. Research from McGraw-Hill reveals the cost-effectiveness of advertising in reaching prospects compared to personal interaction methods. Advertising serves to pre-sell products and attract leads, although it rarely closes sales on its own.

Key Advertising Techniques

B2B advertising uses similar techniques as consumer

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advertising, such as:

-

Importance of Promises

: Clearly identify what’s important to the customer, focusing on factors like responsiveness, support, and service rather than company size.

-

Specific Promises

: Use concrete data (percentages, savings) to appeal to technical audiences.

-

Testimonials

: Use endorsements from recognized experts to build credibility.

-

Demonstrations

: Effective when showing comparative product performance, encourage readers to test the product themselves.

-

News and Information

: Advertisements must highlight new products and provide useful job-related information, as readers of technical journals often look for innovations.

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Ad Format and Style

- Avoid distracting visuals unrelated to the product.
-
Simple Layouts
: Create ads that resemble editorial content to improve engagement.
-
Headlines
: Craft headlines that promise benefits or present significant news; they hold more readership than body copy.
-
Long Copy
: Do not shy away from detailed descriptions—longer copy can attract more readers, especially for complex products.
-
Visuals
: In B2B settings, four-color ads attract significantly more readers than black and white.

Television Advertising

Television is a growing medium for B2B advertising. It can be effective if commercials are concise and substantial,

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emphasizing demonstrations and news. Cost-effective commercials can yield substantial inquiries and results compared to print ads.

Differentiating Commodities

Even seemingly indistinguishable products can stand out through differentiation strategies focused on lower cost or superior service quality. Highlight unique product features that resonate with your target audience.

Stimulating Inquiries

To generate inquiries:
- Always include a toll-free number.
- Use business reply cards and coupons to simplify responses.
- Conclude body copy with clear offers, contact details, and guidelines on how to respond.

Inquiry Analysis

Evaluating inquiry effectiveness includes:
1. Surveying inquiry respondents to determine their intent.

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2. Consulting sales teams on the outcomes of inquiries.
3. Relating inquiries to specific media to optimize advertising budgets and effectiveness.

Targeting Top Management

B2B purchases often require upper management approval. Separate campaigns targeting both top management and technical specialists can improve engagement and communication of benefits, particularly regarding cost savings.

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Example

Key Point:Understand your audience and tailor your message accordingly.

Example:Imagine you're a marketing manager for a software company. When drafting your B2B advertisement, you focus on what matters to the decision-makers: efficiency and cost-effectiveness. You highlight exactly how your software saves time and resources with clear statistics. By presenting testimonials from respected industry leaders, you build credibility and trust. Your headline grabs attention by promising significant improvement in their workflow, while the layout mimics the business reports your audience reads every day, ensuring it resonates well. This targeted approach is crucial for successfully influencing business decision-makers.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The emphasis on using detailed copy and technical data can alienate non-expert audiences.

Critical Interpretation:While David Ogilvy advocates for the use of long copy and concrete data in B2B advertising, this approach may not universally resonate with all decision-makers. Many executives prioritize quick, digestible insights over lengthy technical explanations. Research by G. N. M. Min; A. Reimer emphasizes the shift towards more visual and succinct content in marketing. Thus, while Ogilvy's techniques are grounded in traditional practices, they might inadvertently alienate a portion of the audience who seeks more straightforward communication, suggesting that advertisers should consider a multi-faceted approach that incorporates brevity and visual appeal alongside detailed information.

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Chapter 12 Summary : 12. Direct mail, my first love and secret weapon

Direct Mail: My First Love and Secret Weapon

Introduction to Direct Mail

David Ogilvy recounts his first experience with direct mail, which led to success for a new hotel in London. He emphasizes the effectiveness of direct mail as an underappreciated marketing tool and its impactful role in the growth of Ogilvy & Mather.

The Evolution of Direct Mail

Direct mail has significantly evolved, primarily due to advancements in computer technology. It allows for precise demographic targeting, personalized letters, and efficient list management. Ogilvy notes that it generates over a hundred billion dollars annually in the U.S., especially favored by magazine publishers and retailers.

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Challenges in Direct Mail

Despite its success, the direct mail industry is plagued by fraudulent practices, underscoring the necessity for consumers to exercise caution. However, Ogilvy assures that legitimate campaigns can yield measurable and worthwhile results.

Testing and Measurement

Testing is crucial in direct mail. Advertisers can easily isolate results, allowing for systematic experimentation with variables such as pricing, premiums, and formats. Ogilvy shares examples of successful tests leading to better strategies.

Innovations in Direct Mail

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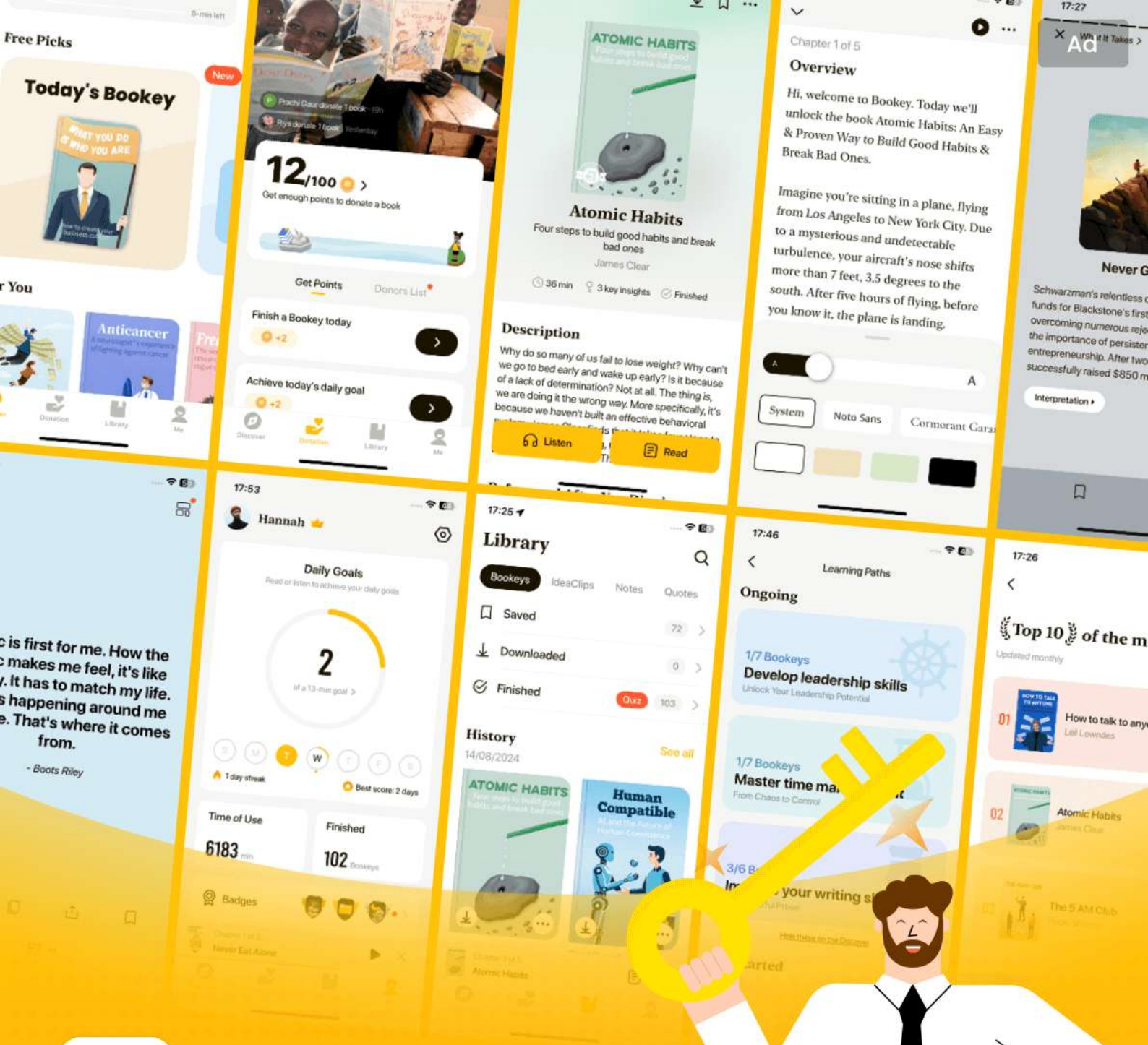

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Chapter 13 Summary : 13. Advertising for good causes

Advertising for Good Causes and Raising Money for Charity

Overview of Advertising for Good Causes

The Advertising Council was established 40 years ago by the advertising industry in the United States to create free campaigns for various charitable causes. In 1979, media outlets provided $600 million worth of free space and time for these campaigns, with agencies volunteering their services. The unpredictability of media generosity poses a challenge, whereas the British system, funded by the government, is more reliable.

Examples of Effective Campaigns

1.
World Wildlife Fund

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: Over five years, Ogilvy & Mather secured $6.5 million in free advertising across 16 countries to promote the World Wildlife Fund, showcasing the impact of such initiatives.

2.

New York Philharmonic

: In a bid to revitalize the orchestra in 1957, Ogilvy & Mather ran a full-page ad in the New York Times detailing the upcoming season's schedule, contributing significantly to improving attendance.

3.

United Negro College Fund

: A compelling letter distributed on commuter trains highlighted the stark contrast between affluent suburbs and the impoverished Harlem, generating $26,000 in contributions in one evening.

4.

Sierra Club

: Howard Gossage’s campaign against a hydroelectric project in the Grand Canyon successfully garnered 3,000 new club memberships while helping to cancel the project.

5.

Teenage Alcoholism in Norway

: The Norwegian government launched a campaign targeting

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teenagers to reduce alcoholism, achieving unprecedented readership and a noted decrease in drinking among youths.

6.

Cancer Awareness in India

: The Indian Cancer Society’s campaign aimed to shift public perceptions about cancer, resulting in a tripling of regular check-ups at clinics within two months.

Challenges in Fundraising through Advertising

Ogilvy warns that while advertisements can increase awareness ("sensitize") about a cause, they rarely generate enough direct contributions to cover ad costs. Effective solicitation typically requires personal engagement to encourage donations.

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Chapter 14 Summary : 14. Competing with Procter & Gamble

Competing with Procter & Gamble

Overview of P&G's Market Dominance

Procter & Gamble (P&G) dominates several consumer product categories, holding a market share of at least 40% in disposable diapers, fabric softeners, and cleansers, among others. With an annual advertising expenditure of $700 million and sales of $12 billion, they set high standards in the advertising landscape.

P&G's Strategic Approach

P&G operates with a disciplined strategy that emphasizes thorough planning, risk minimization, and adherence to proven principles. Key strategies include:

-

Introductory Sampling

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: They invest significantly in product sampling to encourage initial trials.

-

Market Dominance

: P&G aims to dominate every category they enter, achieving economies of scale for lower costs and higher profit margins.

-

Multiple Brands

: The company often launches more than one brand in a category to foster direct competition among its products.

Consumer Insight and Product Superiority

P&G utilizes extensive market research to stay ahead of consumer trends and needs. Their focus on superior product performance ensures that marketed benefits resonate with consumers, making advertising efforts more effective.

Advertising Principles

Their advertising follows several foundational principles:

-

Clear Communication

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: Ads emphasize communicating a single, important benefit effectively.

-

Demonstration and Confirmation

: Many commercials include demonstrations or testimonials to confirm product claims.

-

Targeted Messaging

: Advertising is relatable, using familiar language and settings.

Creative and Testing Practices

P&G maintains a disciplined approach to creative execution:

-

Consistency and Longevity

: Once a successful campaign is established, it is kept running for extended periods.

-

Budget Strategy

: They strategically allocate their advertising budget throughout the year, avoiding stop-and-start patterns.

Vulnerabilities

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Despite their success, P&G is not unbeatable. Product failures, such as Teel detergent and Drene shampoo, highlight their vulnerabilities. Their predictable strategies can also be countered by innovative competitors offering superior products.

Conclusion

While competing with P&G is daunting, opportunities exist for brands that offer better products and innovative marketing approaches. Understanding P&G's strategies provides insights for potential competitors in the consumer goods space.

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Chapter 15 Summary : 15. 18 Miracles of research

Chapter 15: 18 Miracles of Research

Importance of Research in Advertising

David Ogilvy emphasizes that research is crucial in advertising, paralleling its necessity to military strategy. Drawing from his extensive experience in both research and creative roles, he presents 18 key functions that research can fulfill.

Key Functions of Research

1.
Measuring Reputation
: Evaluates company reputation among various stakeholders.

2.
Sales Estimation

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: Predicts sales for new products using mathematical models, determining test marketing viability.

3.

Consumer Reaction Insights

: Gauges reactions to product concepts before market introduction.

4.

Product Comparison

: Assesses how products rate against competition.

5.

Consumer Preferences

: Identifies preferred product attributes such as flavor and color.

6.

Package Testing

: Determines the most effective packaging designs.

7.

Optimal Positioning

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Chapter 16 Summary : 16. What little I know about marketing

Summary of Chapter 16: What Little I Know About Marketing

Understanding Marketing

David Ogilvy expresses his confusion over complicated marketing jargon and theories, emphasizing that practical experience has taught him valuable insights.

Importance of New Products

-
Market Vitality:
A company's vitality is indicated by its introduction of new products.
-
Product Failure:
Eight out of ten new consumer products fail, often due to

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lack of differentiation or being inadequately innovative.

Naming Products

-
Types of Names:
There are three categories of product names: names of people, meaningless names, and descriptive names. Each has its advantages and challenges in market appeal.
-
Research in Naming:
Consumer research can help determine the effectiveness of a product name in terms of memorability and pronunciation.

Advertising Sleeping Beauties

Ogilvy highlights products that were successful without advertising, such as Listerine and Hershey's, showing that advertising can significantly enhance sales.

Market Segmentation

- The traditional "blockbuster brand" approach is becoming less viable. Companies are focusing on niche markets

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instead.
-
Success Over Failure:
Marketers should prioritize enhancing successful products rather than reviving struggling ones.

Time Sensitivity in Marketing

Ogilvy stresses the need for a time-sensitive approach to marketing, suggesting regular progress reviews can lead to profitable outcomes.

Promotions vs. Advertising

- Excessive focus on promotions over advertising can dilute long-term brand value.
- Promotional deals offer temporary boosts but don’t create lasting brand loyalty.

Pricing Strategies

Pricing often relies more on guesswork than scientific methods, and Ogilvy encourages embracing higher quality pricing.

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Marketing During Recession

Historically, companies that maintain advertising during recessions fare better than those that cut back, emphasizing advertising as a necessity, not a luxury.

Focus on Heavy Users

Understanding that a small percentage of consumers account for a large proportion of product usage is crucial for strategic marketing.

Rationale for Advertising

Many manufacturers advertise more to maintain market presence than to boost profits, but Ogilvy champions advertising as a cost-effective method of reaching customers.

Consumer Brand Repertory

Consumers typically have a small group of favored brands they oscillate between, thus initial brand advertising is critical for long-term success.

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Sales Meeting Recommendations

Ogilvy suggests hosting sales meetings in constrained spaces to foster a sense of success and utilizing minimal technology to avoid failures.

Defining Marketing

He concludes by quoting Marvin Bower's definition of marketing as "objectivity," underscoring the essence of clarity and practical insights in marketing strategies.

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Chapter 17 Summary : 17. Is America still top nation?

Is America Still Top Nation?

Global Advertising Landscape

- The United States accounts for approximately half of all global advertising, with American agencies leading in many countries.
- Changes in the industry are evident, with foreign advertising being recognized for its bold and creative approaches.

Differences Between American and British Advertising

- British ads are generally subtle, nostalgic, humorous, and entertaining, in contrast to the direct and competitive American style.
- British advertising is claimed to offer a sense of proportion,

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treating products light-heartedly instead of as life-or-death decisions.

European Advertising Insights

- French advertising is noted for its wit and aesthetic quality, often free from the constraints seen in American and British ads.
- German advertising faces challenges, including a shortage of professionals and television airtime.
- Smaller European markets struggle with budget constraints and lack of research, leading to guesswork rather than informed strategies.

The N.I.H. Syndrome

- Multinational corporations often face pushback from local subsidiaries wishing to develop campaigns that suit local markets rather than adopt international strategies.
- Successful campaigns often translate well across different cultures, and local modifications are usually necessary.

Regional Advertising Developments

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- Latin America, especially Brazil, has seen strides in advertising quality, with Southeast Asia emerging as a strong competitor.
- Australia has improved significantly, whereas New Zealand excels in certain areas.
- India possesses unique challenges due to language and economic factors, often limiting advertising effectiveness.

Advertising in Communist Countries

- Communist nations, contrary to expectations, engage in advertising to some extent, primarily for consumer goods.
- Hungary is noted for producing the best advertising in the communist world, while other countries face bureaucratic hurdles affecting creativity.

China's Advertising Evolution

- Following its 1978 endorsement, advertising in China is still adapting, primarily focusing on industrial products.
- Radio remains the most vital advertising medium in China, with a significant percentage of the population reached via communal systems.

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Conclusion

- While advertising continues to grow in the U.S., its expansion is outpaced by global markets, signaling a shift in professional leadership from America to other countries. The "tortoises" in the advertising race are catching up to the "hare".

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Chapter 18 Summary : 18. Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins and Bernbach

18 Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins, and Bernbach

Six giants who invented modern advertising
This chapter highlights six influential figures in advertising history: Albert Lasker, Stanley Resor, Raymond Rubicam, Leo Burnett, Claude C. Hopkins, and Bill Bernbach, all of whom significantly shaped the advertising landscape in America.

Albert Lasker (1880-1952)

- Originally a reporter, Lasker became the owner of Lord & Thomas, one of the world's largest advertising agencies.
- He popularized the concept of advertising as “salesmanship in print.”
- Emphasized copywriting over art, believing compelling content sold products, exemplified by his work with Kotex.

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- Known for being a workaholic and for his financial acumen, he led the agency to unprecedented profitability.
- Despite his achievements, he had a tumultuous personality and interpersonal challenges.

Stanley Resor (1879-1962)

- As head of J. Walter Thompson, Resor expanded the agency significantly from $3 million to $500 million in billings.
- He managed through consensus and valued teamwork, hiring talented professionals and fostering a collaborative environment.
- Resor championed research in advertising, setting up consumer panels and experiments to inform strategies.
- His pioneering work included employing women as copywriters and creating a partnership dynamic within the agency.
- Ultimately, he resisted modernizing his approaches, which

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Chapter 19 Summary : 19. What’s wrong with advertising?

Section	Summary
Critique of Advertising	Ogilvy discusses criticisms from figures like Toynbee and Galbraith, contrasting them with defenses by Roosevelt and Churchill. He notes that while critics view advertising as harmful, defenders may overstate its benefits. He cites Burnett's view on the limitations of advertising and presents examples of its societal benefits, such as tourism and wildlife promotion.
Truthfulness in Advertising	Ogilvy defends advertising's integrity, arguing that legal regulations help minimize deception. He refutes claims of manipulation by referencing a historical subliminal messaging study and highlights that current regulations make manipulation unlikely.
Political Advertising Issues	Ogilvy criticizes the dishonesty in unregulated political advertising. He points out the misleading tactics in various political campaigns and suggests that the media's obligation to air all political ads contributes to this issue.
Billboards and Aesthetic Concerns	The chapter critiques billboards for their negative impact on public scenery and safety. Ogilvy acknowledges public support for their removal, despite industry opposition.
Inferior Products and Advertising Information	Ogilvy argues that consumers can recognize poor-quality products and thus won't make repeat purchases. He advocates for factual information in advertising to improve consumer satisfaction and suggests prioritizing product improvement over misleading tactics.
Summary Points	1. Economists may see advertising as wasteful, but manufacturers rely on it. 2. Truth in advertising has improved, aside from political deception. 3. Removing billboards would beautify public spaces. 4. Many campaigns fail to provide adequate consumer information.

Chapter 19: What’s Wrong with Advertising?

Critique of Advertising

David Ogilvy highlights ongoing criticisms of advertising from notable figures such as Arnold Toynbee and John

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Kenneth Galbraith, contrasting them with defenses by figures like Franklin Roosevelt and Winston Churchill. He notes that while critics deem advertising to be subversive and polluting, defenders often exaggerate its value. Leo Burnett acknowledges advertising's limitations, arguing it merely serves to sell products effectively. Ogilvy asserts that advertising can benefit society, evidenced by his work promoting tourism and industry in Puerto Rico and the World Wildlife Fund.

Truthfulness in Advertising

Ogilvy defends the integrity of advertising, stating that legal scrutiny ensures that deceptive practices are minimized. He suggests that while the government may produce misleading advertisements, commercial advertising faces ethical reviews. The author dismisses accusations of manipulation in advertising, referencing a historical uninformed experiment on subliminal messaging and emphasizing that regulation makes manipulation highly unlikely today.

Political Advertising Issues

Ogilvy expresses concern about the unregulated nature of

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political advertising, which he regards as fundamentally dishonest, highlighting the discrepancies between commercial and political advertisements. He mentions various political campaigns, illustrating how misleading tactics overshadow truth. He suggests that the media's obligation to air political ads irrespective of content contributes to this dishonesty.

Billboards and Aesthetic Concerns

The chapter critiques the impact of billboards on public scenery and safety, referencing various public figures advocating against them. Ogilvy suggests that the prevalence of billboards often compromises beautiful landscapes and acknowledges public support for removing them, despite industry resistance.

Inferior Products and Advertising Information

Ogilvy counters the notion that advertising can induce consumers to buy poor-quality products, asserting that consumers quickly discern quality and refrain from repeat purchases. He advocates for using factual information in advertising to enhance customer experience and satisfaction,

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recommending that product improvement should be prioritized over misleading advertising tactics.

Summary Points

1. Economists may see advertising as an economic waste, but manufacturers view it as vital.
2. Aside from deceptive political advertising, truth in advertising has improved significantly.
3. Eliminating billboards would enhance public spaces.
4. Many advertising campaigns lack sufficient information for consumers.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Advertising's Dual Nature

Critical Interpretation:Ogilvy presents a dualistic view of advertising, acknowledging both its societal benefits and criticisms regarding misinformation. However, one might question whether the glorification of advertising oversimplifies its complexities. Critics argue that the persuasive nature of advertising can often override truthfulness, suggesting that consumers may not always make informed choices. This perspective is supported by studies revealing that advertising can create cognitive biases, leading consumers to favor branded products over generic alternatives regardless of quality (source: “Effects of advertising on consumer behavior,” Journal of Marketing Research). Thus, while Ogilvy defends advertising as a tool for societal good, it's crucial to critically evaluate its influence on consumer decision-making and the ethical implications of creating desire for potentially inferior products.

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Chapter 20 Summary : 20. I predict 13 changes

I predict 13 changes

David Ogilvy outlines his predictions for the future of advertising, emphasizing potential advancements and shifts in the industry:

1. Improved Research Quality

Research will enhance knowledge about effective advertising strategies, leading to better financial results.

2. Renaissance in Print Advertising

Print advertising will experience a revival.

3. Informative Advertising

Ads will increasingly provide substantial information rather than empty rhetoric.

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4. Abolition of Billboards

Billboards are predicted to be eliminated from the advertising landscape.

5. Control of Commercial Clutter

The overwhelming number of commercials on TV and radio will be managed more effectively.

6. Government Advertising for Education

Governments will significantly increase their use of advertising for educational purposes, particularly in health.

7. Addressing Population Growth

Advertising will contribute to efforts aimed at controlling population growth.

8. Honest Political Advertising

Political candidates will move away from dishonest

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advertising practices.

9. Global Advertising Standards

The quality of international advertising will rise, with foreign agencies surpassing American firms.

10. Foreign Agencies in the U.S.

Numerous foreign agencies will establish operations in the United States and succeed.

11. Rise of Multinational Brands

Multinational companies will expand market shares globally, adapting advertising campaigns to local cultures.

12. Integration of Direct-Response Advertising

Direct-response advertising will merge with general advertising agencies.

13. Cost-effective TV Commercials

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New methods will emerge to create effective TV commercials at lower costs.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The potential renaissance in print advertising reflects a major shift in media consumption.

Critical Interpretation:Ogilvy predicts that print ads will see a revival, echoing a belief in their enduring power due to tactile engagement and focused readership. However, with the continuing trend towards digital media consumption, this viewpoint raises critical questions about the evolution of consumer attention spans and the effectiveness of print in an increasingly screen-dominated environment. Data from sources like Statista and Pew Research, indicating shifts in advertising spending and consumer media habits, could challenge Ogilvy's optimism, suggesting that even a renaissance may not capture significant market share in the face of evolving technologies.

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Best Quotes from Ogilvy on Advertising by David Ogilvy with Page Numbers

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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 9-14

1. ‘Let us march against Philip’
2. I do not regard advertising as entertainment or an art form, but as a medium of information.
3. Consumers still buy products whose advertising promises them value for money, beauty, nutrition, relief from suffering, social status and so on.
4. I comfort myself with the reflection that I have sold more merchandise than all of them put together.
5. Nothing could be further from the truth. I hate rules.

Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 15-43

1. ‘I have seen one advertisement actually sell not twice as much, not three times as much, but 19½ times as much as another.'
2. 'You don’t stand a tinker’s chance of producing successful advertising unless you start by doing your homework.'

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3.'The personality of a product is an amalgam of many things – its name, its packaging, its price, the style of its advertising.'

4.'It takes a big idea to attract the attention of consumers and get them to buy your product.'

5.'If you are too lazy to do this kind of homework, you may occasionally luck into a successful campaign, but you will run the risk of skidding about on what my brother Francis called ‘the slippery surface of irrelevant brilliance.’

6.'Every advertisement should be thought of as a contribution to the brand image.'

7.'I shudder to think how many I have rejected. Research can’t help you much, because it cannot predict the cumulative value of an idea, and no idea is big unless it will work for thirty years.'

8.'If your advertising isn’t working and your sales are going down... do you want to see the goddamned sales curve stop moving down and start moving up?'

9.'The average time it takes them to produce a campaign is

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117 days – faster than goats but slower than hyenas.'

10.'If you and your competitors all make excellent products, don't try to imply that your product is better.'

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 44-66

1. 'Most good copywriters', says William Maynard of the Bates agency, 'fall into two categories. Poets. And killers. Poets see an ad as an end. Killers as a means to an end.' If you are both killer and poet, you get rich.
2. 'Be happy while you're living, for you're a long time dead.'
3. 'Learn to write lucid memoranda. The senior people to whom they are addressed have more homework than you do.'
4. 'You will never become a successful account executive unless you learn to make good presentations.'
5. 'If you will take my advice, don't get a job in advertising unless it interests you more than anything in the world.'

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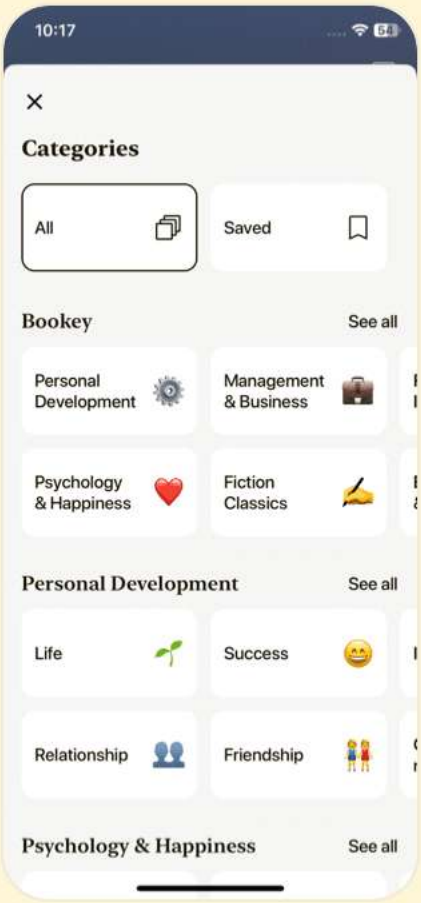

Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 67-93

1. ‘If each of us hires people who are smaller than we are, we shall become a company of dwarfs, but if each of us hires people who are bigger than we are, Ogilvy & Mather will become a company of giants.’
2. ‘Make it fun to work in your agency. When people aren’t having any fun, they don’t produce good advertising.’
3. ‘Never hire your friends. I have made this mistake three times, and had to fire all three. They are no longer my friends.’
4. ‘Good leaders are decisive. They grasp nettles.’
5. ‘A man who spendeth his life gathering gold for the United States Treasury and has no fun, is a sounding ass and a tinkling idiot.’

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 94-107

1. The easiest way to get new clients is to do good advertising.
2. If you are going to choose your agency on the basis of

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price, you are looking through the wrong end of the telescope.

3. The differences between agencies are less than they like to believe.
4. Creativity is not a function of size. Small can be beautiful.
5. Never pay a commission to an outsider who offers to introduce new business.
6. If you boast about your genius for brilliant ideas, you run the risk that they will ask you why you don't give them brilliant ideas.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 108-114

1. Clients get the advertising they deserve. I know some who are a malediction, and others who are an inspiration.
2. Don't keep a dog and bark yourself.
3. Once a year give your agency a formal report on its performance.
4. Even the best copywriters are preternaturally thin-skinned. When you have to reject their work, do it gently, and praise

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them to the skies when they perform well.

5.I would think twice about firing my agency when it committed bigamy; another agency might not give you such good advertising.

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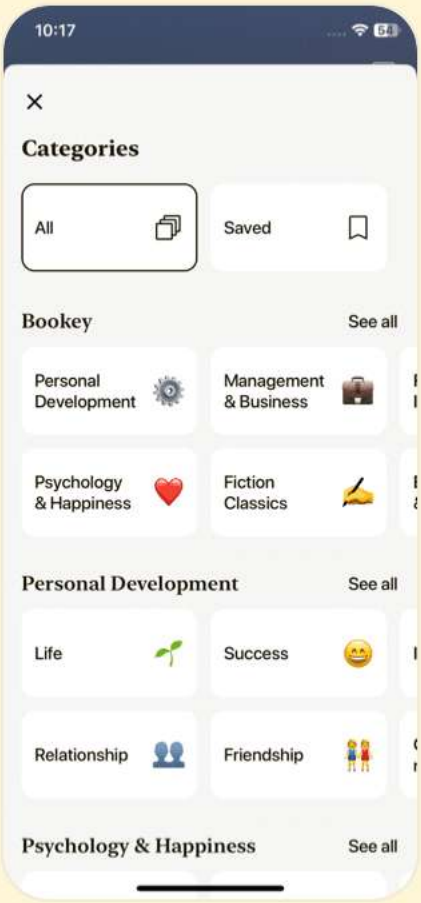

Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 115-147

1. ‘God is in the details’
2. 'On the average, five times as many people read the headlines as read the body copy.'
3. 'Ads with news are recalled by 22 per cent more people than ads without news.'
4. 'You cannot bore people into buying your product. You can only interest them in buying it.'
5. 'I advise you to include the brand name in your headline.'
6. 'The more facts you tell, the more you sell.'
7. 'Every morning hundreds of old and battered Zippos arrived in the mail. They were returned the same day, in perfect working order – and no charge.'
8. 'The eye is a creature of habit.'
9. 'If you pretend you are an editor, you will get better results.'
10. 'You can’t save souls in an empty church.'

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 148-168

1. ‘People don’t buy from clowns’
2. ‘I have come to believe that commercials with a large

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content of nostalgia, charm and even sentimentality can be enormously effective.'

3. 'When you have nothing to say, sing it.'
4. 'All too often they attribute your commercial to a competing brand.'
5. 'It pays to show the product being used, and, if possible, the end-result of using it.'
6. 'The easiest way to reduce the cost of a commercial is to cut actors out of the storyboard.'
7. 'Everything is possible on TV. The technicians can produce anything you want. The only limit is your imagination.'
8. 'If your advertising is going to be successful, if it is going to stand out from the clutter, you must be objective about the benefits of your product.'

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 169-182

1. 'With public opinion on its side, nothing can fail' - Abraham Lincoln
2. 'my father was ashamed when I went to work for Sears. Today, nobody is ashamed to work for Sears. Thank you.'

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3. ‘The public be damned.’
4. ‘If you think this trivial, reflect that if a corporation has a market value of forty billion dollars – and some do – that extra 2 per cent adds up to $800,000,000. Not to be sneezed at.’
5. ‘But the majority of corporate advertising campaigns are aborted too soon to achieve any measurable objective.’
6. ‘Many corporate campaigns fail because they are under-funded.’
7. ‘Disarm with candor.’
8. ‘When Congress was considering a windfall profits tax on oil companies, several of them ran argumentative advertisements directed to Congressmen.’
9. ‘A classic example of simplifying a complicated issue was the headline on a Chesapeake and Ohio advertisement: ‘A Hog Can Cross the Country Without Changing Trains – But YOU Can’t!’
10. ‘When you add television, tracking studies record a dramatic increase in penetration.’

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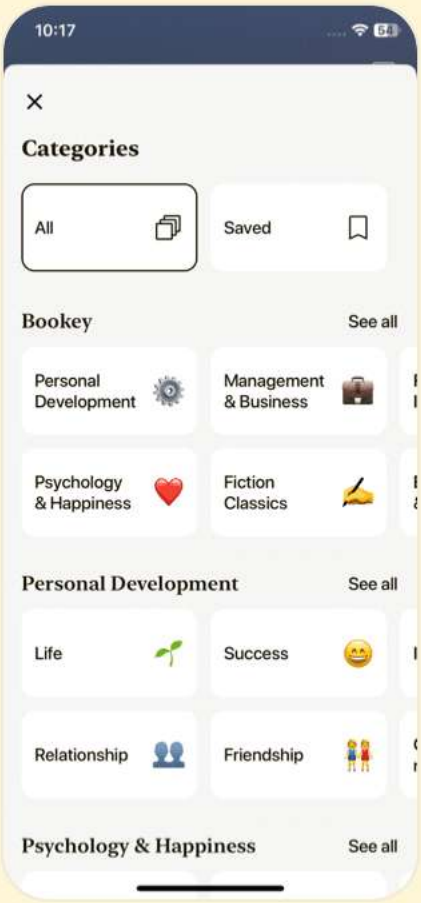

Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 183-191

1. People dream about visiting foreign countries. The job of your advertising is to convert their dreams into action.
2. When you advertise countries which are little known, it pays to give the reader a lot of specific information.
3. If you want to persuade the Swiss to visit the United States, don't advertise ski resorts. If you want Frenchmen, don't advertise American food.
4. Sometimes you will find it advisable to change the image of the country you advertise.
5. My beloved Puerto Rico had the most unfortunate image of all. Research revealed that Americans who had never been there believed it to be dirty, ugly and squalid.

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 192-201

1. An effective strategy in business advertising is to show the reader how he can calculate the money your product would save him.
2. Some copywriters, assuming that the reader will find the

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product as boring as they do, try to inveigle him into their ads with pictures of babies, beagles and bosoms. A mistake.

3. The most successful commodity products differentiated themselves in one of two ways: either by low cost or by having the best reputation for quality or service.
4. Always put a toll-free number in your advertisements, to make the inquiry as fast and as easy as possible.
5. If your headline doesn’t sell, you have wasted your money.

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 202-213

1. From that day on, I have been a voice crying in the wilderness, trying to persuade the advertising establishment to take direct mail more seriously...
2. In direct mail, testing is the name of the game.
3. When collections of Moscow Olympic Games silver, gold and platinum coins were sold by direct mail, a mailing which offered only the silver coins led to more sales of the complete collection than a mailing which offered the complete collection itself.

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4. The price you ask and the terms of payment you offer are critical, and they can be tested by sample mailings.
5. Innovations, provided you test them, can work wonders.
6. The better the program on which your commercials appear, the fewer sales you make.
7. Successful mailings do not always depend on premiums, brochures and other such paraphernalia. I have seen letters produce satisfactory results all by themselves.

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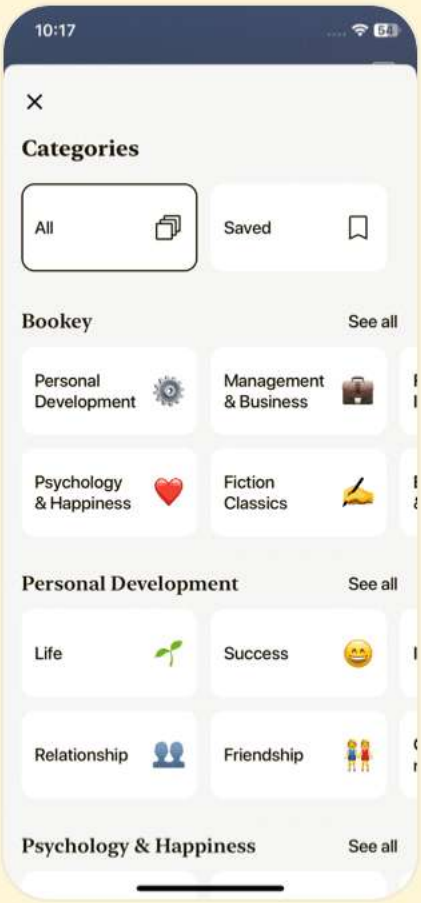

Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 214-220

1. ‘When this train emerges from the tunnel at 108th Street this evening, look out of the window’.
2. 'I vomit almost every time I drink'.
3. ‘Life after cancer… it’s worth living’.
4. ‘I love the advertising business. I truly do, although it’s no business of a grown man. I love it because it’s such a lovely Augean stable to clean up.’
5. It is rare for any advertisement, however powerful, to bring in enough direct contributions to pay for the cost of the space.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 221-228

1. ‘The key to successful marketing is superior product performance.…If the consumer does not perceive any real benefits in the brand, then no amount of ingenious advertising and selling can save it.’
2. ‘Patience,’ says their President, ‘is one of the virtues of this company.’ They would rather be right than first.

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3. ‘We are forever trying to see what lies around the corner.…We study the consumer and try to identify new trends in tastes, needs, environment and living habits.’
4. They always promise the consumer one important benefit. When they perceive that there is an opportunity to increase sales by promising more than one, they sometimes run two campaigns at the same time – often in the same medium.
5. Only three products in the history of P&G have gone national without being test-marketed for at least six months. Two of them failed.

Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 229-245

1. ‘Promise, large promise is the soul of an advertisement,’ said Samuel Johnson.
2. ‘The chances of your having said it are only fair.’
3. ‘Only last year Starch reported that advertisements with headlines that promise a benefit are read by an average of four times more people than advertisements that don’t.’
4. ‘When you say something, make sure you have said it.’
5. ‘If you think that advertising to children is satanic, skip the

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next two pages.’

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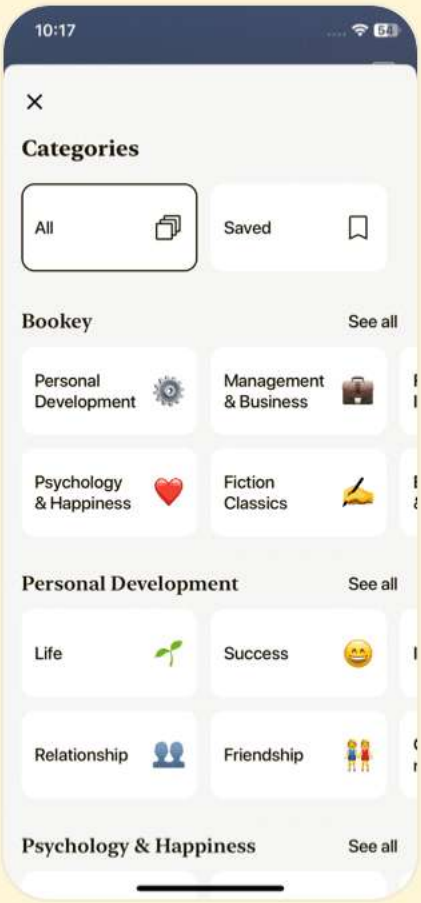

Chapter 16 | Quotes From Pages 246-258

1.'You can judge the vitality of a company by the number of new products it brings to market.'

2.'The opposite is seen in the pharmaceutical industry. Merck, for example, spends $200,000,000 a year on new-product research.'

3.'If you stop advertising a brand which is still in its introductory phase, you will probably kill it – for ever.'

4.'In the long run, the manufacturer who dedicates his advertising to building the most sharply defined image for his product gets the largest share of the market.'

5.'Most marketers spend too much time worrying about how to revive products which are in trouble, and too little time worrying about how to make successful products even more successful.'

6.'Consider your target audience's motivations, and keep your eye glued to the heavy users.'

7.'When Jerry Lambert scored his breakthrough with Listerine, he speeded up the whole process of marketing by

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dividing time into months.'

8.'I have come to regard advertising as part of the product, to be treated as a production cost, not a selling cost.'

9.'The task of advertising is not primarily one of conversion but rather of reinforcement and assurance.'

10.'Always hold your sales meetings in rooms too small for the audience, even if it means holding them in the WC.'

Chapter 17 | Quotes From Pages 259-271

1. ‘all over the world, admen look to Madison Avenue as Moslems look to Mecca.’

2. ‘the best of foreign advertising seems brasher, fresher and more outrageous than ours’.

3. ‘There seems to be a realization in England that maybe, just maybe, the product being sold is not the most important thing in the consumer’s mind.’

4. ‘The best way to settle these arguments is to test the international campaign in each country.’

5. ‘What is the significance of a Western jingle to a person who dances beautifully to the sound of a bamboo flute?’

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6. ‘The elimination of human suffering is too serious to leave to government alone.’
7. ‘the volume of advertising is still growing in the United States, it is growing faster in the rest of the world, and America is no longer top nation professionally.’

Chapter 18 | Quotes From Pages 272-306

1. ‘The history of advertising could never be written without first place being given to John E. Kennedy, for every copywriter throughout the length and breadth of this land is today being guided by the principles he laid down.’
2. ‘I make my men so good that I can’t keep ‘em.’
3. ‘The way we sell is to get read first.’
4. ‘Somewhere along the line, after I’m finally off the premises, you may want to take my name off the premises, too. But let me tell you when I might demand that you take my name off the door. That will be the day when you spend more time trying to make money and less time making advertising.’

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5.‘If you know these things about a man, you can touch him at the core of his being. One thing is unchangingly sure. The creative man with an insight into human nature, with the artistry to touch and move people, will succeed. Without them he will fail.’

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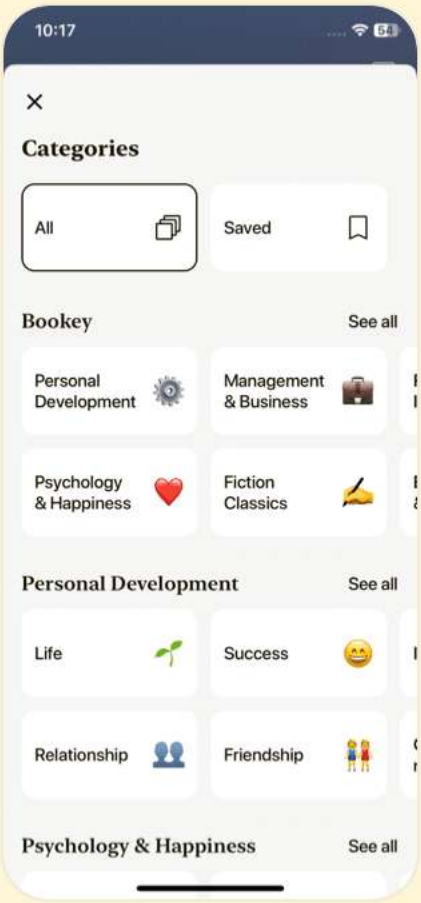

Chapter 19 | Quotes From Pages 307-326

1. ‘Advertising is not the noblest creation of man’s mind, as so many of its advocates would like the public to think. It does not, single-handedly, sustain the whole structure of capitalism and democracy and the Free World.’
2. ‘I feel no qualms of conscience about persuading you that you do [need a dishwasher]. What the Calvinistic dons don’t seem to know is that buying things can be one of life’s more innocent pleasures, whether you need them or not.’
3. ‘If advertising were abolished, what would be done with the money? Would it be spent on public works? Or distributed to stock-holders in the form of extra dividends?’
4. ‘It is not unknown for an advertisement in a newspaper to be read by more people than any news item.’
5. ‘The best way to increase the sale of a product is to improve the product.’
6. ‘I did not feel ‘evil’ when I wrote advertisements that

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attracted tourists and industry to a country which had been living on the edge of starvation for 400 years.’

Chapter 20 | Quotes From Pages 327-329

1. The quality of research will improve, and this will generate a bigger corpus of knowledge as to what works and what doesn’t.
2. There will be a renaissance in print advertising.
3. Advertising will contain more information and less hot air.
4. The clutter of commercials on television and radio will be brought under control.
5. There will be a vast increase in the use of advertising by governments for purposes of education, particularly health education.
6. Candidates for political office will stop using dishonest advertising.
7. The quality and efficiency of advertising overseas will continue to improve – at an accelerating rate.
8. Several foreign agencies will open offices in the United States, and will prosper.

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9. Multinational manufacturers will increase their market-shares all over the non-Communist world, and will market more of their brands internationally.
10. Direct-response advertising will cease to be a separate speciality, and will be folded into the ‘general’ agencies.
11. Ways will be found to produce effective television commercials at a more sensible cost.

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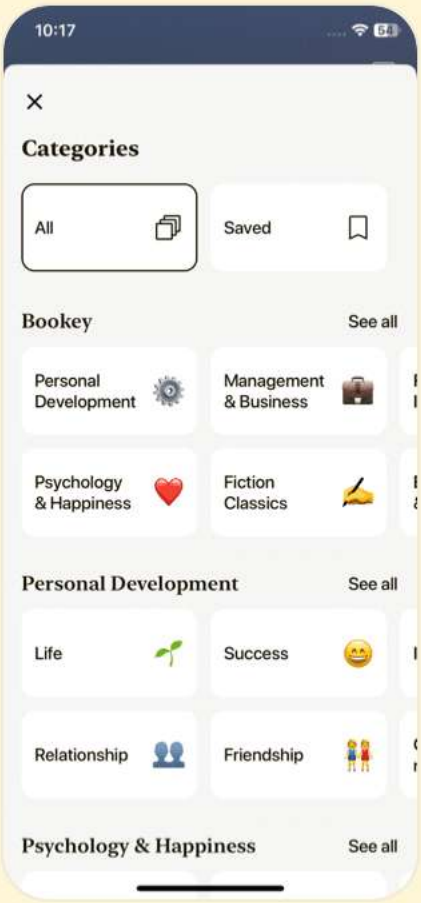

Ogilvy on Advertising Questions

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Chapter 1 | 1. Overture| Q&A

1.Question

How does David Ogilvy define the purpose of advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy sees advertising not as entertainment or art, but as a medium of information designed to engage consumers' interest and drive them to purchase products.

2.Question

What perspective does Ogilvy believe age provides in understanding advertising?

Answer:He suggests that age might offer a beneficial perspective, allowing one to distinguish between timeless advertising principles and fleeting trends, rather than disqualifying him from discussing contemporary advertising.

3.Question

What major change in advertising does Ogilvy acknowledge since he began his career?

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Answer:The emergence of television as a dominant medium for advertising is highlighted as the sole major change he has witnessed since he started in 1949.

4.Question

How does Ogilvy respond to critics who claim that older advertising techniques are obsolete?

Answer:He asserts that many techniques that have been around for years continue to be effective, countering the arguments of critics by citing ongoing consumer behavior that shows these methods still resonate.

5.Question

What does Ogilvy say about the importance of research in advertising?

Answer:He emphasizes the role of research in understanding consumer reactions, suggesting it is not about imposing rules but reporting insights that can guide effective advertising strategies.

6.Question

Who is Ogilvy's intended audience for this book?

Answer:The book is targeted at both young hopefuls in the

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advertising field and veterans seeking to improve their success in generating sales.

7.Question

What analogy does Ogilvy use to illustrate the sharing of knowledge in advertising?

Answer:He likens the dissemination of advertising knowledge to obstetricians in 18th-century England who guarded their practices' secrets until one medical student revealed their technique, emphasizing the importance of sharing expertise for the benefit of all.

8.Question

How does Ogilvy view the public's perception of creativity in advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy prefers that advertisements be judged on their ability to sell products rather than being labeled as 'creative,' which he believes can detract from their primary function.

9.Question

What does Ogilvy mean when he mentions 'difficilis, querulus, laudator temporis acti'?

Answer:He refers to the potential criticism he faces for being

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difficult, complaining, and favoring the ways of the past, while asserting the validity of his insights and experience in advertising.

Chapter 2 | 2. How to produce advertising that sells| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of homework in producing effective advertising?

Answer:Doing thorough homework is crucial because it helps you truly understand the product you're selling. Knowledge gained from research allows you to create compelling ideas that resonate with your target audience, leading to successful advertising that can dramatically increase sales.

2.Question

What was the impact of using the right appeal in advertising, as illustrated by John Caples' observation?

Answer:Caples emphasized that the difference in appeal in two similar ads led to a staggering 19½ times increase in sales for one of them. This underlines the importance of targeting

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the right emotions and needs of consumers to drive sales.

3.Question

How does understanding competitors' advertising help in crafting your own ads?

Answer:By analyzing competitors, you can identify gaps in their messaging, understand what appeals to consumers, and differentiate your product effectively, leading to a stronger market position.

4.Question

What does positioning mean in advertising, and why is it important?

Answer:Positioning refers to defining what your product does and for whom it is intended. It’s critical because it shapes consumer perception and provides clarity in a competitive market, enabling more effective targeting.

5.Question

Why is a product's image important, and how should it be projected in advertising?

Answer:A product's image represents its personality and influences customer perception. Consistently projecting a

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well-defined image in advertising is vital, as it helps establish trust and appeal among consumers.

6.Question

What constitutes a 'big idea' in advertising and why is it essential?

Answer:A 'big idea' captures attention and makes a lasting impression, often leading to sales. It is the unique concept behind an advertisement that can sustain interest and relevance over time.

7.Question

What is the relationship between advertising simplicity and product focus?

Answer:Simplicity in advertising often leads to clarity, and when the product is the hero of the advertisement, it allows for straightforward messaging that resonates more powerfully with consumers.

8.Question

What does David Ogilvy suggest about the role of committees in advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy warns against committees, arguing that they

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often dilute creativity and effectiveness. He believes that too many viewpoints can complicate campaigns, leading to watered-down ideas.

9.Question

How can advertising utilize the concept of 'positive goodness'?

Answer:Instead of claiming superiority over competitors, advertisers should focus on proving that their product is reliably good. This strategy can create consumer confidence and encourage selection based on perceived quality.

10.Question

Why should successful advertisements be repeated, according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Repeating successful advertisements can capitalize on their effectiveness, as readership does not significantly decline with repetition. A good ad can keep attracting new customers as market conditions change.

11.Question

What insights can be gathered from direct response advertising techniques?

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Answer:Direct response advertisers base their strategies on measurable outcomes. Their focus on longer copy, precise targeting, and effective time slots for ads can provide valuable lessons for general advertisers.

12.Question

How does Ogilvy view creativity in advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy criticizes the notion of originality for originality's sake, advocating instead for ideas that reliably drive sales. He emphasizes that effective advertising should prioritize functionality over abstract creativity.

13.Question

What is Ogilvy's stance on using sex in advertising?

Answer:While acknowledging that sex can be relevant in some contexts, Ogilvy asserts that irrelevance can detract from the product's message. He encourages advertisers to ensure that sexual content serves a purpose in promoting the product.

14.Question

What does Ogilvy mean by 'the cult of creativity,' and how does it affect advertising effectiveness?

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Answer:Ogilvy satirizes the obsession with creativity that sometimes prioritizes artistic expression over effective selling. He argues that the real measure of advertising success should be its impact on sales rather than its aesthetic appeal.

Chapter 3 | 3. Jobs in advertising – and how to get them| Q&A

1.Question

What are the four different career paths available in advertising according to David Ogilvy?

Answer:1. Selling time or space at television networks, radio stations, magazines, or newspapers.

2. Working as a copywriter, art director, or advertising manager for a retailer.

3. Becoming a brand manager at a manufacturing company.

4. Joining an advertising agency.

2.Question

What is the most important quality for a successful copywriter?

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Answer:A potentially successful copywriter should have obsessive curiosity about products, people, and advertising, a sense of humor, and a habit of hard work.

3.Question

How does one become a successful account executive?

Answer:To become a successful account executive, one should aim to be the best-informed person about the client's account, conduct thorough research, and learn to make effective presentations.

4.Question

What skills are necessary for a Creative Director in advertising?

Answer:A Creative Director should possess psychological insight, high standards, administrative efficiency, strategic thinking, research acumen, and good presentation skills.

5.Question

What advice does Ogilvy give on applying for a job in advertising?

Answer:Write a well-crafted cover letter, be direct and personal, and clearly state your intentions for a follow-up.

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6.Question

What does Ogilvy think about the public perception of advertising professionals?

Answer:Ogilvy notes that the public often views advertising professionals as less credible, ranking them low on honesty, but he believes that many in the field are proud of their work.

7.Question

Why does Ogilvy recommend moonlighting for advertising professionals?

Answer:He suggests moonlighting to supplement income and gain additional experience, emphasizing that it has benefited him throughout his career.

8.Question

What is Ogilvy's perspective on women in advertising?

Answer:He notes that more women are being recruited for professional roles in advertising and acknowledges their capability and rising status within agencies.

9.Question

What is the significance of continuous learning in a career in advertising?

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Answer:Ogilvy emphasizes that what you learn early in your advertising career is more important than your initial salary, highlighting the value of training and skill development.

10.Question

What does Ogilvy say about the nature of work in advertising agencies?

Answer:He describes the atmosphere in advertising agencies as stimulating and energetic, ensuring employees will never be bored due to the variety of work and challenges.

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Chapter 4 | 4. How to run an advertising agency| Q&A

1.Question

What are the essential qualities needed to successfully run an advertising agency?

Answer:Running an advertising agency requires resilience, leadership, and the ability to maintain team morale in a high-pressure environment. One must be a skilled salesperson, capable of overcoming natural anxieties that come from the unpredictable nature of client relationships and creative output.

2.Question

How can an agency leader maintain a positive work environment?

Answer:Agency leaders can create a positive work atmosphere by infusing humor and fun into the workplace, consequently promoting creativity and productivity. Encouraging open communication and celebrating achievements can significantly enhance morale.

3.Question

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What role does hiring talent play in the success of an advertising agency?

Answer:Hiring exceptional talent is crucial; talented copywriters, account executives, and creative directors are the backbone of an agency's success. Leaders should seek individuals with curiosity, creativity, and a passion for advertising, thereby fostering an environment where innovative ideas can flourish.

4.Question

Why should an agency avoid hiring friends and family?

Answer:Hiring friends or family can complicate professional relationships and lead to uncomfortable situations when performance issues arise. The potential for personal relationships to interfere with business decisions often results in an unhealthy work environment.

5.Question

What is the importance of leadership in an advertising agency?

Answer:Effective leadership is paramount as it not only

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drives the agency forward but also inspires team members. Great leaders embody confidence and resilience, encouraging their teams to thrive even in the face of challenges.

6.Question

How should an agency handle internal politics?

Answer:To control internal politics, agency leaders should promote a culture of transparency, discourage favoritism, and encourage direct communication to resolve conflicts. This approach minimizes competition for power and fosters a cooperative environment.

7.Question

What strategies can help an agency improve its overall discipline?

Answer:Implementing strict punctuality, respecting deadlines, and maintaining high professional standards are essential to cultivating discipline within the agency. Providing incentives for adherence to these standards can bolster accountability among staff.

8.Question

How does the pressure of working in advertising refine

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individuals within the industry?

Answer:Pressure in the advertising industry can serve as a refining force, prompting individuals to excel and innovate rather than crumble. It fosters resilience and adaptability, turning challenges into opportunities for growth.

9.Question

What measures can leaders employ to identify potential leaders among their staff?

Answer:To spot future leaders, agency heads should look for individuals who show leadership qualities early in their careers, such as involvement in college activities, strong analytical skills, and the capacity to look at problems from an overall viewpoint.

10.Question

What financial strategies can advertising agencies adopt to ensure profitability?

Answer:Agencies can adopt a fee-based compensation model to ensure that each account pays for its own needs, minimizing cross-subsidization and allowing more

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straightforward financial planning. Additionally, reinvesting profits into growing the firm's core competencies can maintain profitability.

Chapter 5 | 5. How to get clients| Q&A

1.Question

What is the most effective way to acquire new clients according to David Ogilvy?

Answer:The easiest way to get new clients is to do good advertising. Ogilvy emphasized that showcasing successful advertising campaigns can attract new business, as demonstrated by his own agency's success in winning accounts simply by presenting their creative work.

2.Question

How did David Ogilvy recommend handling meetings with prospective clients?

Answer:Ogilvy suggested mixing the client's team with his own during meetings to create a collaborative atmosphere rather than an adversarial one. He also advised against

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reading from prepared texts, stressing the importance of listening to the client and showing transparency about one's agency's weaknesses to build credibility.

3.Question

What should agencies focus on when presenting to potential clients?

Answer:Agencies should focus on the selling power of their advertising rather than price. Ogilvy highlighted that clients should be more concerned with the effectiveness of their advertising campaigns rather than merely the cost of hiring an agency.

4.Question

How can the personality of an agency head affect new business opportunities?

Answer:The personality of the agency head can be a decisive factor in winning accounts. Ogilvy noted that many clients were attracted to agencies simply because they were impressed by the agency head's style, emphasizing that an appealing personality can open doors, while an off-putting

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demeanor can close them.

5.Question

What should agencies do about credit risks when considering new clients?

Answer:Ogilvy advised being cautious about credit risks and suggested consulting with the head of the incumbent agency if there's doubt about a potential client's financial stability, as it is crucial for an agency's profitability.

6.Question

What was Ogilvy's perspective on small agencies versus large agencies?

Answer:Ogilvy believed that small agencies often possess the ability to out-perform larger ones in terms of creativity, even though big agencies can handle larger accounts. He pointed out that creativity does not depend on size, and smaller agencies could still thrive.

7.Question

How did Ogilvy suggest agencies should promote themselves?

Answer:He noted that many agencies fail to advertise

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themselves effectively and recommended that they define their messaging goals before creating house ads. Ogilvy highlighted the importance of consistent promotion, taking inspiration from examples like Young & Rubicam who advertised regularly in major publications.

8.Question

What lesson did Ogilvy learn from turning down small companies like Xerox?

Answer:Ogilvy regretted not recognizing the potential of smaller companies, illustrating that some non-traditional clients can turn into major advertisers if given the chance. This reflects the importance of being open-minded and considering opportunities that may initially seem unpromising.

9.Question

What strategy did Ogilvy use to expand into international markets?

Answer:Ogilvy employed a 'domino system' for acquiring new business by leveraging existing multinational accounts

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to gain additional clients in different countries. This strategy helped him build a global network by capitalizing on existing relationships and the need for cohesive advertising across markets.

10.Question

What critical insight about agencies did Ogilvy provide regarding reputation?

Answer:Ogilvy advised agencies to seek external, impartial assessments of their reputation within the marketing community. He noted that internal perceptions may be biased, and independent research could help identify areas for improvement in how the agency is viewed.

Chapter 6 | 6. Open letter to a client in search of an agency| Q&A

1.Question

What should a client consider when selecting an advertising agency?

Answer:A client should carefully evaluate agencies based on their work, making a shortlist by examining advertisements they admire. They should

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also prioritize chemistry with the agency heads and ensure that the agency's past work resonates with their vision. It's paramount that the selection process is personal rather than delegated to a committee, which can lead to poor choices.

2.Question

What is the importance of chemistry between a client and an agency?

Answer:Chemistry is crucial as it fosters collaboration and a productive partnership. An inspiring relationship can amplify the creativity and effectiveness of the advertising efforts, leading to campaigns that truly resonate with the audience.

3.Question

How should clients communicate feedback to their agency?

Answer:Clients should provide gentle, constructive feedback when rejecting work, while also praising successful campaigns enthusiastically. This approach builds morale and encourages agencies to continue delivering their best work.

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4.Question

Why is it recommended to have a five-year contract with an agency?

Answer:A five-year contract secures a long-term partnership that allows the agency to invest time and resources in the client's business without the fear of losing the account suddenly to competitors.

5.Question

What is the downside of involving too many people in the approval process for advertisements?

Answer:Involving too many levels in the approval process can dilute creativity and slow down decision-making. Only the Chief Executive Officer should have final approval, as too many vetoes can cripple an agency's output.

6.Question

What lesson can be learned about the role of a client in the advertising process?

Answer:The client should understand that their role is to empower and inspire the agency rather than micromanage. By allowing the agency creative freedom and trusting their

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expertise, the client can achieve more impactful advertising outcomes.

7.Question

How should a client view the concept of agency conflicts?

Answer:Clients may need to reconsider the rigidity around conflicts of interest; sometimes, firing an agency over a perceived conflict might lead to losing out on exceptional advertising. Instead, one should value the unique insights and creativity that agency can provide.

8.Question

What advice is given for smaller accounts looking for quality advertising?

Answer:For clients with smaller budgets who want quality work, hiring a retired and experienced copywriter may be a beneficial alternative. This allows for personalized service and expertise at a fraction of the cost of a larger agency.

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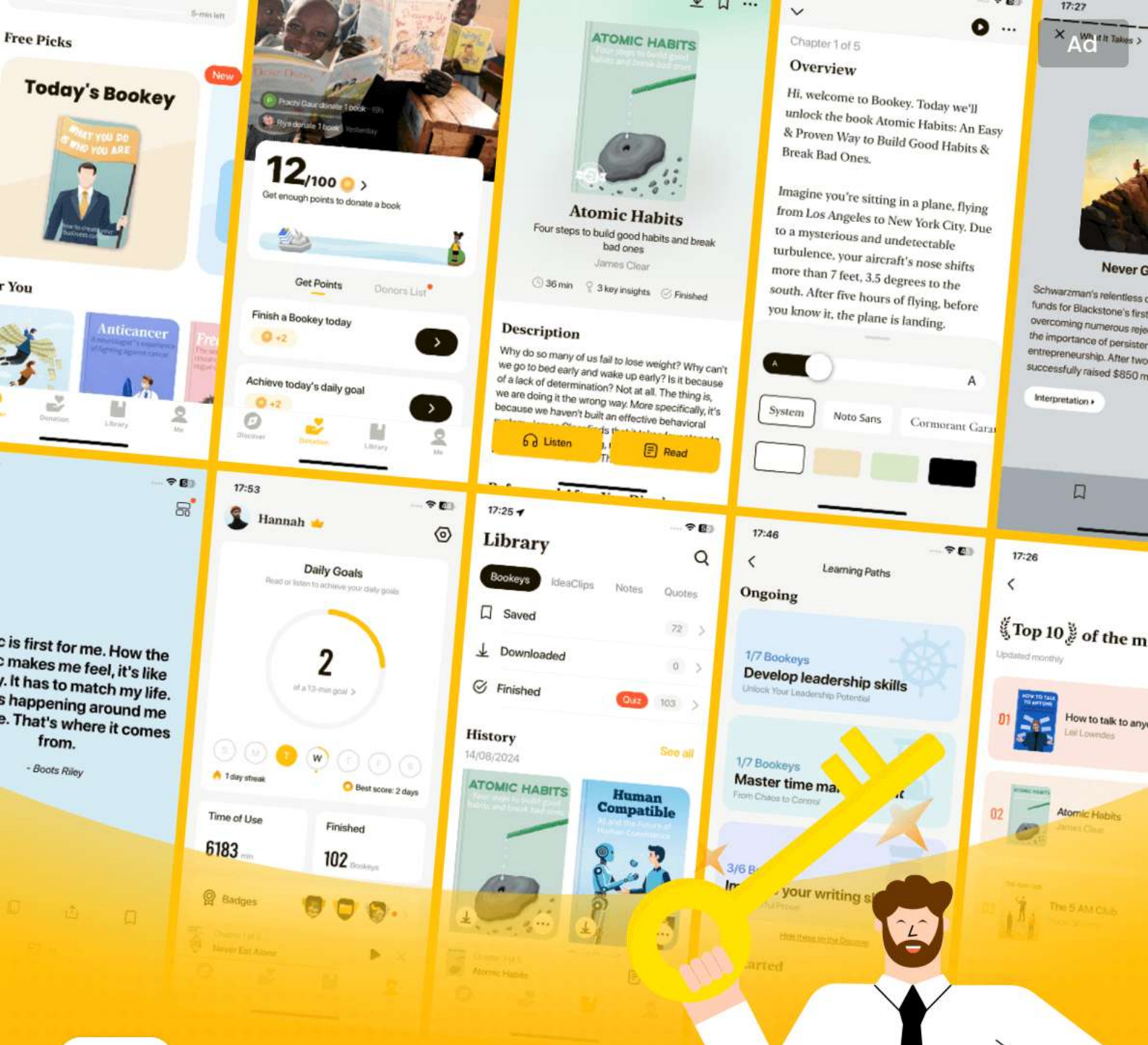

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Chapter 7 | 7. Wanted: a renaissance in print advertising| Q&A

1.Question

What main advantage does television advertising have over print advertising according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Television advertising is seen as more exciting by agency people because it can visually enhance their talents and allows for glamorous location shoots, unlike print advertising which often gets neglected.

2.Question

How does Ogilvy suggest advertisers can improve the effectiveness of their headlines?

Answer:Ogilvy suggests that headlines should promise a benefit, provide news, or include helpful information. Specificity and emotional impact are crucial; headlines should be straightforward and easily understood by the reader.

3.Question

What is the importance of audience targeting in print

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advertisements?

Answer:Targeting is essential in print ads; listing specific demographic indicators in the headline flags down the intended audience, ensuring that the advertisement resonates with the right consumers.

4.Question

What insight does Ogilvy provide about the relationship between long copy and sales?

Answer:Ogilvy argues that long copy tends to sell more than short copy for many products because it communicates more information, making the ad seem important. Successful examples demonstrate that well-written long copy can significantly increase sales.

5.Question

Why is the psychological aspect of typography emphasized in advertising, according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Typography affects readability, and good typography makes it easier for consumers to engage with the advertisement. Poor readability leads to missed

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communication of the ad’s message, reinforcing the principle that 'God is in the details'.

6.Question

How can the use of testimonials influence an advertisement's effectiveness?

Answer:Testimonials, especially from experts or fellow consumers, can enhance credibility and persuasiveness, making readers more likely to believe the advertisement.

7.Question

What does Ogilvy mean by 'advertisements should not look like advertisements'?

Answer:Ogilvy encourages advertisers to design ads that resemble editorial content rather than traditional ads to attract and engage more readers, as people are more inclined to read articles than advertisements.

8.Question

What was Ogilvy’s advice regarding the placement of headlines and illustrations?

Answer:He found that placing headlines below illustrations generally leads to higher readership since it aligns with the

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natural reading progression of looking first at images and then the supporting text.

9.Question

What specific techniques does Ogilvy suggest for writing compelling body copy?

Answer:He advises writing as if addressing an individual, using short sentences, avoiding jargon, engaging starting lines, and strategically employing subheads and cross-heads to maintain visual interest.

10.Question

In what way did Ogilvy suggest using emotional storytelling in advertisements?

Answer:By crafting the body copy as a narrative or story, advertisers can capture interest more effectively, demonstrated through iconic examples that incorporated human experiences to engage potential customers.

Chapter 8 | 8. How to make TV commercials that sell| Q&A

1.Question

What are some effective techniques in TV commercials to

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change brand preference?

Answer:1. Humor: Recent research shows that humor can positively impact sales, contrary to earlier beliefs.

2. Slice of Life: Showing real-life situations that lead to product endorsement.

3. Testimonials: Authentic testimonials from loyal users can enhance credibility.

4. Demonstrations: Showcasing product performance in an engaging way is compelling.

5. Problem Solution: Present a familiar problem and demonstrate how your product solves it.

6. Talking Heads: Direct pitches by recognized personalities can effectively launch new products.

7. Characters: Long-running brand characters build product association over time.

8. Reason Why: Providing logical reasons for a product's superiority can sway viewers.

9. News: Any new information about the product

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can capture viewer interest.

10. Emotion: Emotional appeals connected with nostalgia or charm are impactful, especially for common products.

Chapter 9 | 9. Advertising corporations| Q&A

1.Question

What are the benefits of corporate advertising according to David Ogilvy?

Answer:Corporate advertising can enhance a company's reputation, boost employee morale, aid in recruitment, attract investors, and even positively influence stock prices. Notably, if people know a company well, they are five times more likely to have a favorable opinion of it.

2.Question

Why do most corporate advertising campaigns fail?

Answer:Most corporate campaigns fail due to unclear objectives, lack of research to track progress, and insufficient funding. Many campaigns are abandoned too quickly, often

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because they are not adequately supported by corporate management.

3.Question

How can corporate advertising influence public opinion?

Answer:Corporate advertising can influence public opinion if it simplifies complex issues, presents cases in terms of self-interest, disarms with honesty, provides balanced views, and targets the general public rather than just thought leaders or legislators.

4.Question

What is the significance of public opinion in business according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Public opinion is crucial for business success; a favorable public perception can lead to success, while a negative one can result in failure. Ogilvy highlights that aligning with public sentiment is essential for the longevity and profitability of corporate initiatives.

5.Question

Can you give an example of a successful corporate advertising strategy mentioned in the chapter?

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Answer:A prime example is the long-standing corporate advertising by Container Corporation, which differentiated itself from competitors, effectively branded itself, and maintained recognition over decades, illustrating the importance of consistent and clear messaging.

6.Question

What does Ogilvy warn Chief Executive Officers about appearing in their own commercials?

Answer:Ogilvy humorously warns that CEOs may become easier targets for kidnappers due to their visibility and suggests they might not deliver lines as effectively as professional announcers, hinting at the importance of maintaining brand professionalism.

7.Question

What mistake do corporations make concerning the naming of their companies?

Answer:Changing names to initials can confuse the public, as many initials fail to convey the full identity of a company, resulting in wasted advertising dollars trying to educate the

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public on brand recognition.

8.Question

What methodology does Ogilvy suggest for setting advertising budgets?

Answer:Ogilvy suggests analyzing the task at hand to determine how much it will cost to achieve specific goals among targeted audiences rather than blindly allocating funds based on previous spending patterns.

9.Question

How can corporate advertising be used to address social or political issues effectively?

Answer:By presenting a transparent and responsible image, acknowledging public concerns, and engaging in a dialogue that recognizes both sides of an issue, corporations can build trust and influence opinions on social and political matters positively.

10.Question

What is one of Ogilvy's key principles regarding corporate messaging?

Answer:Corporate messaging should avoid pompous

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language and self-serving phrases. It needs to be clear, relatable, and meaningful to resonate with the audience effectively.

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Chapter 10 | 10. How to advertise foreign travel| Q&A

1.Question

What is the primary objective of advertising foreign travel according to David Ogilvy?

Answer:The primary objective is to convert people's dreams of visiting foreign countries into action by combining appealing images and specific information about the destination.

2.Question

How does Ogilvy suggest handling negative perceptions or image issues of a location?

Answer:He suggests using research to identify misconceptions and then illustrating the actual beauty or advantages of the location through advertisements, such as the positive portrayal he gave Puerto Rico.

3.Question

What did Ogilvy find to be the most significant factor in the success of tourism advertising?

Answer:The subjects chosen to illustrate in the

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advertisements, emphasizing unique aspects of the country that cannot be experienced elsewhere.

4.Question

Why is it essential to use specific information in advertisements for lesser-known countries?

Answer:Specific information helps potential travelers feel informed and secure about their destination, addressing fears and uncertainties regarding travel to unfamiliar places.

5.Question

What challenge arises when advertising travel to the United States from Europe, according to Ogilvy?

Answer:The challenge is balancing the interests of various states and locations, as political influences can dictate what is featured in advertisements, potentially misaligning with tourist interests.

6.Question

What two fears do American tourists have about traveling abroad, as highlighted by Ogilvy?

Answer:The two fears are cost and communication barriers, both of which serve as significant obstacles to international

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travel.

7.Question

How does Ogilvy recommend differentiating a country in travel advertising?

Answer:He advises using unique aspects of that country that cannot be found elsewhere and employing creative headlines or multilingual elements to make the advertisements stand out.

8.Question

What are some examples Ogilvy uses to illustrate the success of targeted advertising?

Answer:Successful advertising campaigns for various locations like the Come to Britain campaign and the portrayal of Puerto Rico transformed their images, resulting in increased tourism.

9.Question

What role do cultural perceptions play in Ogilvy's approach to tourism advertising?

Answer:Cultural perceptions significantly impact how tourists view a destination; thus understanding and

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addressing these perceptions can help create more effective advertising strategies.

10.Question

How does Ogilvy view the relationship between advertising and public perception of a destination?

Answer:Ogilvy believes advertising can shape public perception and expectations by properly positioning a destination, showcasing its strengths and reducing misconceptions.

Chapter 11 | 11. The secrets of success in business-to-business advertising| Q&A

1.Question

What is the primary purpose of business-to-business advertising according to David Ogilvy?

Answer:The primary purpose of business-to-business advertising is not to close a sale but to pave the way for salesmen by pre-selling the product and attracting leads. It helps potential customers understand what’s available in the market.

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2.Question

How can businesses effectively differentiate their products in a market perceived as selling commodities?

Answer:Businesses can differentiate their products by emphasizing low costs or establishing a strong reputation for quality or service. For example, Owens-Corning successfully differentiated its insulation products by branding them specifically for homeowners wanting to reduce fuel costs, despite insulation generally being seen as a commodity.

3.Question

What insights does McGraw-Hill provide about the cost-effectiveness of advertising versus sales calls?

Answer:McGraw-Hill indicates that reaching a prospect through advertising costs only 17 cents, compared to $178 for a sales call, which makes advertising a significantly more cost-effective means of reaching potential business customers.

4.Question

What role do testimonials play in business-to-business advertising, and how should they be selected?

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Answer:Testimonials are highly effective when they come from recognized experts in reputable companies, as they lend credibility and trust to the product. For example, a testimonial from a seasoned professional in the industry is more persuasive than an endorsement from an unknown figure.

5.Question

What type of information should business-to-business advertising prioritize in its messaging?

Answer:Business-to-business advertising should prioritize specific, relevant information that promises benefits to the customer, such as percentages, time saved, or cost reductions. For instance, an advertisement might demonstrate how a product can save the buyer money in measurable terms.

6.Question

How important are headlines in business-to-business advertising, and what should they convey?

Answer:Headlines are crucial in business-to-business

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advertising as they often receive five times the readership of body copy. A good headline should promise benefits, deliver important news, or address a key problem that resonates with the target audience.

7.Question

What strategy should businesses adopt when targeting top management for their products or services?

Answer:When targeting top management, businesses should focus on broad benefits such as cost savings rather than intricate details that matter to specifiers. Creating distinct campaigns for each audience can be an effective strategy.

8.Question

What is the significance of including a toll-free number in business advertising?

Answer:Including a toll-free number in advertisements makes it easier for potential customers to inquire about products, significantly increasing the likelihood of receiving inquiries, as many readers prefer immediate and hassle-free communication.

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9.Question

Why might long copy be more effective in certain business-to-business advertisements?

Answer:Long copy can be more effective for complex products such as computers or generators, as it allows for more detailed explanations and technical information, drawing in interested readers who want a deeper understanding of the product.

10.Question

What common mistakes do copywriters make in business-to-business advertising, and what should they avoid?

Answer:A common mistake is using irrelevant imagery, such as pictures of babies or animals, to attract attention. Instead, copywriters should focus directly on the product and its benefits, recognizing that the audience is specifically interested in the product being advertised.

Chapter 12 | 12. Direct mail, my first love and secret weapon| Q&A

1.Question

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What was David Ogilvy's breakthrough moment with direct mail?

Answer:Ogilvy's breakthrough moment occurred when he successfully used penny postcards to promote a country hotel. By mailing these postcards to affluent individuals in the neighborhood, he achieved a full house for the hotel's opening, inspiring his lifelong passion for direct mail advertising.

2.Question

Why does Ogilvy emphasize the importance of testing in direct mail?

Answer:Ogilvy stresses that testing is crucial because it allows advertisers to measure the effectiveness of different variables, such as pricing and terms of payment. By testing one variable at a time, marketers can identify what works best, leading to increased sales and profitability.

3.Question

How has technology influenced direct mail in advertising?

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Answer:Technology, particularly computers, has revolutionized direct mail by enabling precise segmentation of mailing lists according to various demographics, purchasing behaviors, and preferences. This capability has led to more targeted and effective mailings, contributing to substantial revenue growth in direct mail advertising.

4.Question

What approach should advertisers take when offering free premiums?

Answer:Advertisers should test different premiums to determine which ones attract long-term customers. While appealing initial offers like cash prizes in sweepstakes can evoke instant responses, it’s essential to assess whether such customers will remain loyal to the brand.

5.Question

What does Ogilvy suggest about the length of copy in advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy advocates for long copy, especially when selling higher-ticket items. He argues that comprehensive

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copy allows for a detailed explanation of the product's benefits, which is crucial for convincing customers to make significant investments.

6.Question

What is the role of headlines in print advertisements according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Headlines are the most critical element of print advertisements. A compelling headline that promises a strong benefit can significantly increase the response rate, even more so than other elements in the ad.

7.Question

How can advertisers handle the issue of response rates diminishing over repeated advertisements?

Answer:Ogilvy advises that when advertising in the same magazine, response rates often drop. Advertisers should watch for optimal performance opportunities across different magazines and test their ads during various runs to avoid diminishing returns.

8.Question

What key insights does Ogilvy offer regarding television

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commercials?

Answer:Successful television commercials should present a problem and demonstrate how the product solves it, include a money-back guarantee, and provide clear ordering instructions. Longer commercials (preferably two minutes or longer) tend to engage viewers more effectively than shorter spots.

9.Question

Why does Ogilvy recommend avoiding cluttered ad layouts?

Answer:Ogilvy has observed that clear, well-organized layouts lead to higher response rates. Excessively cluttered layouts can confuse potential customers and detract from the ad's message, reducing the likelihood of engagement.

10.Question

What significance does the concept of a 'control' mailing hold in direct mail advertising?

Answer:In direct mail advertising, a 'control' mailing is an established mailing that has proven profitable. Advertisers

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should use this as a baseline for testing new strategies or variations to enhance response rates and profitability, ensuring continuous improvement.

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Chapter 13 | 13. Advertising for good causes| Q&A

1.Question

What role does advertising play in raising funds for charitable causes?

Answer:Advertising serves primarily to raise awareness and sensitization about charitable causes, making the public more receptive to personal solicitation methods for donations. For instance, campaigns for the World Wildlife Fund generated awareness, although direct cash contributions were modest, leading to more effective fundraising efforts later on.

2.Question

Can a single advertisement be effective in raising significant funds for charity?

Answer:Generally, a single advertisement is not enough to generate significant direct contributions. Instead, it is more about raising awareness and educating the public. For example, the campaign for the United Negro College Fund

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used a targeted letter on commuter trains, which resulted in $26,000 in one night, demonstrating that a well-placed ad can spark immediate donations, but consistent effort is usually required.

3.Question

How did Ogilvy's strategy revitalize the New York Philharmonic?

Answer:Ogilvy purchased ad space in the New York Times that showcased the complete concert schedule for the Philharmonic, which helped to attract audiences back to performances at a time when the orchestra was struggling with low attendance. This initiative played a significant role in restoring the institution's viability.

4.Question

What impact did the campaign against teenage alcoholism in Norway have?

Answer:The campaign, which initially targeted youths and later addressed parents, achieved unparalleled readership and sparked a significant media discussion, ultimately leading to

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a decrease in teenage drinking after years of increase.

5.Question

Why is it important for people to understand charitable causes before donating?

Answer:Understanding charitable causes is essential for encouraging contributions. People are less likely to donate to a charity unless they have knowledge about its mission and impact, as demonstrated by various campaigns that aimed to educate the public on subjects ranging from cancer awareness to conservation efforts.

6.Question

What did Howard Gossage believe about the purpose of advertising?

Answer:Howard Gossage believed that advertising should primarily serve social purposes rather than just commercial interests. He argued that its true value lies in its ability to effect positive change and mobilize people for worthy causes, as exemplified by his campaigns for the Sierra Club.

7.Question

What were the outcomes of the advertising campaign for

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cancer awareness in India?

Answer:The campaign successfully shifted public attitudes from ignorance to understanding regarding cancer, leading to a tripling of check-ups at free clinics within two months as more people began to seek information and participate in health screenings.

8.Question

What is a potential drawback of using advertising for good causes in the U.S.?

Answer:A significant drawback is the variability in media generosity; campaigns rely on free ad space, which can be unpredictable. In contrast, the British system, where the government finances campaigns, allows for greater control and reliability over funding.

9.Question

How can we measure the effectiveness of charitable advertising?

Answer:Effectiveness can be measured through increased awareness and engagement rather than direct financial

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contributions. For example, advertising may yield a high response rate in terms of signature submissions or membership applications, even if monetary donations do not immediately follow.

10.Question

What insights can advertisers gain from Ogilvy's experiences with charitable campaigns?

Answer:Advertisers can learn the importance of creativity, storytelling, and understanding the audience's context when crafting messages for good causes. Engaging people on an emotional level tends to yield better results in fundraising efforts.

Chapter 14 | 14. Competing with Procter & Gamble| Q&A

1.Question

What strategies does Procter & Gamble employ to ensure their overwhelming success in advertising and product sales?

Answer:Procter & Gamble employs several key strategies: they are highly disciplined, thoroughly

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plan their advertising strategies, and minimize risks. They utilize massive scale sampling campaigns to get product trials, ensuring consumers have firsthand experiences. They focus on significant categories to dominate market share and achieve lower manufacturing costs. They conduct extensive market research to understand consumer needs and trends, deliver superior product performance, and consistently test before launching new products. Their advertising promises a single key benefit and communicates effectively, often using demonstrations to reinforce claims.

2.Question

How does Procter & Gamble approach advertising budgets and strategies over time?

Answer:Procter & Gamble establishes a comprehensive advertising budget and continually tests higher expenditure levels. They maintain their campaigns for extended periods, sometimes lasting over ten years, while regularly testing new

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executions. This long-term commitment is complemented by consistent advertising throughout the year rather than using flighting techniques, which allows them to save costs and maintain a steady presence in the market.

3.Question

What is the significance of product superiority in P&G's marketing strategy?

Answer:Product superiority is crucial in P&G's marketing strategy as it forms the foundation of their promise to consumers. If customers do not perceive significant benefits from the product, no amount of clever advertising can save it. P&G conducts blind in-home tests to ensure that their products perform better than others and that this superiority is recognized by consumers, which in turn drives their advertising effectiveness.

4.Question

How does P&G utilize consumer connection in their advertising campaigns?

Answer:P&G's advertising campaigns connect directly with

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consumers by using familiar language and relatable scenarios. They incorporate real-life demonstrations and testimonials, depicting how their products can improve daily life. Their commercials often feature ordinary people rather than celebrities, focusing on emotional benefits and practical results to resonate with consumers on a personal level.

5.Question

In what ways can smaller brands compete successfully against Procter & Gamble?

Answer:Smaller brands can compete against Procter & Gamble by focusing on marketing superior products, as demonstrated by Bell Brand potato chips and Rave shampoo, which succeeded due to better taste and formulation, respectively. Additionally, understanding and anticipating P&G's predictable strategies can create a tactical advantage. By emphasizing unique benefits or targeting niche segments that P&G might overlook, smaller brands can carve out their own market share.

Chapter 15 | 15. 18 Miracles of research| Q&A

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1.Question

Why is it important for advertising professionals to utilize research in their campaigns?

Answer:Ignoring research in advertising is akin to a general overlooking enemy signals in war. Research equips advertisers with insights into consumer behavior, preferences, and market dynamics, enabling them to craft effective, targeted messages and potentially avoid costly mistakes. For example, through research, Ogilvy discovered that a client’s $600,000 investment in a product line for senior citizens was met with lackluster interest, prompting the client to cancel the project (a 'dry hole'). This highlights how working without research can lead to significant losses.

2.Question

What does Ogilvy mean when he says 'Promise, large promise is the soul of an advertisement'?

Answer:Ogilvy emphasizes the necessity of a strong,

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compelling promise in advertisements to capture consumer attention and drive sales. He cites Samuel Johnson, who stresses that advertisements lacking a promise do not sell. For instance, ads that clearly communicate a benefit, like 'makes a perfect cup of coffee every time,' are more effective than those that do not highlight any specific consumer benefit.

3.Question

How can research contribute to defining a target audience?

Answer:Research allows for a deep understanding of demographic aspects such as age, gender, income, education, lifestyle, and media habits. By analyzing these factors, advertisers can accurately identify their target audience, ensuring that their advertising campaigns are effectively tailored. For example, knowing whether to target young or old consumers can significantly influence advertising strategies and the choice of media.

4.Question

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What role does testing play in developing effective advertising promises?

Answer:Testing different advertising promises through methods like split-run testing allows advertisers to measure which headlines or claims resonate most with consumers. This process helps in identifying not only effective messaging but also unique selling propositions that can differentiate a product in the marketplace.

5.Question

How can research help in evaluating product positioning?

Answer:Research enables advertisers to gauge consumer perceptions of a product in comparison to its competitors. For instance, consumer feedback can guide decisions about which product attributes should be emphasized in marketing content. If a product is seen as inferior, it can be sent back to development for reformulation.

6.Question

What common pitfalls should advertisers be aware of when conducting surveys?

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Answer:Advertisers should remain vigilant of common issues, such as respondents providing socially desirable answers instead of honest opinions, or surveys failing to convey the true effectiveness of an advertisement. Misleading questions or improper formats can greatly skew results. Ogilvy mentions a case where people claimed to have read 'Gone With the Wind' out of a desire to seem cultured.

7.Question

Why might some advertising professionals view research as inhibiting creativity?

Answer:Some advertising professionals may perceive research as a constraint, fearing it limits innovative ideas and bold creative choices. However, Ogilvy argues that research can stimulate creativity by providing data that inspires fresh ideas, such as discovering that using French headlines for French tourism campaigns outperformed English ones.

8.Question

What regulatory challenges do advertisers face when marketing to children?

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Answer:Advertisers must navigate a strict set of regulations designed to protect children from exploitative marketing practices. These include prohibitions on manipulative messaging that implies peer acceptance depends on product ownership, and requirements for transparency regarding product functionalities. This makes it increasingly challenging to convey messages to young audiences.

9.Question

What final takeaway does Ogilvy provide on the relationship between research and advertising effectiveness?

Answer:Despite some misuse of research in advertising, Ogilvy firmly believes in its power to enhance the effectiveness of campaigns. He advocates for using research not as a crutch, but as a tool to enrich creativity and validate ideas, leading to better outcomes in terms of consumer engagement and sales.

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Chapter 16 | 16. What little I know about marketing| Q&A

1.Question

What can be inferred about the importance of innovation in marketing from Ogilvy's observations?

Answer:Ogilvy emphasizes that the vitality of a company is often judged by its ability to introduce new products, stating that 35% of supermarket sales come from products that didn't exist a decade prior. He critiques companies that rely too heavily on inherited products and highlights the necessity of having a distinguishable point of difference in new offerings to succeed.

2.Question

How does Ogilvy suggest handling new product names?

Answer:Ogilvy outlines three types of product names: names based on people, meaningless names, and descriptive names. He advocates for names that are memorable and suggest human innovation while also cautioning against overly specific names that may limit future expansions.

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3.Question

What role does advertising play during economic recessions according to Ogilvy?

Answer:Ogilvy asserts that cutting advertising during recessions can be detrimental to brands. He cites studies showing companies that maintain their advertising budgets during tough times achieve greater profit increases, suggesting that advertising should be viewed as an essential cost rather than an expendable one.

4.Question

What advice does Ogilvy give regarding promotions versus advertising?

Answer:He warns against prioritizing promotions over advertising, arguing that while promotions might provide short-term boosts in sales, they don't foster long-term brand loyalty. Instead, he suggests that building a compelling brand image through consistent advertising yields more sustainable market share.

5.Question

What does Ogilvy mean by ‘Sleeping Beauties’ in

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marketing?

Answer:Ogilvy uses 'Sleeping Beauties' to refer to established products that can significantly benefit from advertising, even if they had previously thrived without it. He provides examples like Listerine and Hershey, where marketing revitalized their sales and profits.

6.Question

How does Ogilvy define the connection between pricing and consumer perception?

Answer:He notes that higher prices often enhance desirability, yet he indicates there is little correlation between price and product quality, advocating that superior products can be marketed at premium prices without fearing consumer rejection.

7.Question

What lessons does Ogilvy provide about focusing on heavy users?

Answer:Ogilvy highlights that heavy users account for the majority of product consumption, suggesting marketers

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should prioritize understanding and appealing to this segment rather than trying to attract occasional users who have different motivations.

8.Question

Why does Ogilvy suggest that marketing meetings should be held in small rooms?

Answer:He advises conducting sales meetings in cramped spaces to create a sense of urgency and success, contrasting with larger, half-empty venues that may project an image of failure.

9.Question

What is Ogilvy's definition of marketing?

Answer:David Ogilvy succinctly defines marketing as 'objectivity,' emphasizing the importance of clear and rational thought in approaching marketing challenges.

Chapter 17 | 17. Is America still top nation?| Q&A

1.Question

How does American advertising compare to British advertising according to Ogilvy?

Answer:American advertising tends to be more

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direct, competitive, and assertive, often utilizing techniques like talking heads and slice-of-life narratives. In contrast, British advertising is characterized by its subtlety, humor, and entertainment value, presenting products in a more laid-back and less competitive manner. Ogilvy suggests that British advertisers have a better sense of proportion regarding the importance of the product, often making light of the purchasing decisions in a playful way.

2.Question

What is the 'N.I.H. Syndrome' and how does it affect advertising practices in multinational corporations?

Answer:The 'Not Invented Here' (N.I.H.) Syndrome describes the resistance from local agency managers in multinational corporations to adopt advertising campaigns created elsewhere. They feel such campaigns threaten their self-respect, arguing that local markets have unique characteristics that require locally tailored campaigns. This

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tension can delay effective global marketing efforts and encourages the practice of testing international campaigns locally before implementation.

3.Question

What challenges do advertisers face in India?

Answer:Advertisers in India have to navigate significant challenges such as a multilingual population, low literacy rates, and limited advertising budgets. Most people can’t read, and the vast majority have very low incomes, making it difficult to justify advertising products that many cannot afford. Furthermore, the issues of a growing population and government underfunding of family planning complicate the advertising landscape.

4.Question

How is advertising in China evolving, and what does it indicate about the market's growth?

Answer:Advertising in China has only been permitted since 1978, indicating a significant shift in market strategy. Initially considered evil, the government's endorsement

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denotes an embrace of modern marketing techniques. However, the current advertising often still resembles straightforward specification sheets rather than creative marketing campaigns, showing that while the industry is growing, it still has a way to go in adopting more sophisticated advertising practices.

5.Question

What lessons can be drawn from the advertising achievements in countries like Thailand and Brazil?

Answer:The advertising successes in Thailand and Brazil highlight the effectiveness of cultural relevance in marketing. In Thailand, the creative use of local cultural symbols resonated deeply with audiences, proving that tailored content can outperform generic multinational campaigns. Similarly, Brazil's targeted creativity showcases the power of authentic local voices, indicating that understanding and embracing local culture is crucial for effective advertising.

6.Question

What does Ogilvy suggest about the future of American advertising in a global context?

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Answer:Ogilvy suggests that while American advertising has dominated historically, it is now facing stiff competition from global markets where creativity and relevance are increasing. The observation that 'the tortoises are overtaking the hare' symbolizes the rise of more innovative and culturally attuned advertising in other nations, implying that American advertising may need to adapt to remain competitive on the global stage.

7.Question

How does the advertising landscape differ between Eastern and Western countries?

Answer:Eastern countries, particularly communist ones, often deal with constraints such as limited budgets and a focus on state-controlled messaging. Advertising here tends to be more utilitarian and less creative due to bureaucratic influences. On the other hand, Western countries generally have more freedom in creative expression, along with a greater focus on brand storytelling and emotional engagement in advertising campaigns.

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8.Question

What role does humor play in British advertising as described by Ogilvy?

Answer:Humor is a significant element in British advertising, according to Ogilvy. British ads often use humor to present their products in a light-hearted way, which can engage consumers more effectively. By employing nostalgia and entertainment, British advertisers manage to make their campaigns memorable, indicating a deep understanding of the cultural context and consumer mindset.

9.Question

What findings does Ogilvy present regarding advertising effectiveness across different markets?

Answer:Ogilvy finds that certain advertising campaigns perform well universally, suggesting shared interests and preferences across diverse markets. For instance, pieces that successfully showcased product benefits, like the good mileage with Shell, resonated similarly in the U.S., Canada, and Europe. This indicates that while localization is essential,

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there are fundamental truths in advertising that transcend cultural differences.

Chapter 18 | 18. Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins and Bernbach| Q&A

1.Question

What traits did the six giants of advertising share, according to Ogilvy?

Answer:All six giants were American, had previous careers before entering advertising, were known for their intense work ethic and perfectionism, had significant reputations as copywriters, and surprisingly, only three of them had university degrees.

2.Question

How did Albert Lasker revolutionize the advertising industry?

Answer:Albert Lasker revolutionized advertising by defining it as 'salesmanship in print', focusing on the effectiveness of copywriting over other elements like research and artistry. He innovated campaigns like positioning Kotex products for

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customer convenience, demonstrating a keen understanding of consumer behavior.

3.Question

What impact did Stanley Resor have on J. Walter Thompson and the advertising industry?

Answer:Stanley Resor transformed J. Walter Thompson from a modest agency into the world's largest, valued for his ability to attract and retain top talent, and by fostering a respectful, collaborative environment. He was a pioneer in utilizing research and employing women in advertising.

4.Question

What was Raymond Rubicam's philosophy on advertising?

Answer:Raymond Rubicam believed in the responsibility of advertising to behave ethically. He emphasized research's role in the creative process and advocated for the significance of strong, creative work while opposing the idea that client demands should compromise advertising integrity.

5.Question

How did Leo Burnett define his approach to advertising?

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Answer:Leo Burnett emphasized finding the inherent drama in products and connecting with the consumer authentically, suggesting that advertising should be deeply rooted in American values and folklore. He instilled a creative process that thrived on competition among teams to generate exceptional work.

6.Question

What significance did Claude Hopkins have in advertising principles?

Answer:Claude Hopkins is renowned for his scientific approach to advertising, which included pioneering techniques like test marketing and advertising effectiveness measurement. His belief that copy should act as a strong selling tool without pretension laid the groundwork for direct response marketing.

7.Question

What set Bill Bernbach apart from the other advertising giants?

Answer:Bill Bernbach was distinguished by his commitment

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to creativity and originality, integrating copy and visual design seamlessly. He rejected the prevailing research-driven approach, believing it hindered creativity, and advocated that understanding unchanging human nature was key to effective advertising.

8.Question

How did these giants influence modern advertising?

Answer:The collective philosophies and practices of these giants laid the foundational principles of modern advertising, emphasizing creativity, ethical behavior, research application, effective copywriting, and the importance of understanding consumer psychology, which remain relevant in today's advertising landscape.

9.Question

What recurring theme can be identified in the principles of these advertising giants?

Answer:A recurring theme among these giants is the combination of creativity with a deep understanding of the consumer. They believed that effective advertising must not

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only sell products but resonate on a human level, maintaining integrity while pushing the boundaries of creativity.

10.Question

What lessons can current advertisers learn from Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins, and Bernbach?

Answer:Current advertisers can learn the value of hard work, creativity, strategic use of research, authenticity in messaging, and the ethical responsibility inherent in advertising. They also highlight the importance of adapting to consumer needs and continuously innovating to stay relevant.

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Chapter 19 | 19. What’s wrong with advertising?| Q&A

1.Question

What criticisms do some economists and thinkers make about advertising?

Answer:They argue that advertising serves as a subversive force, trivializes our values, and manipulates consumers, essentially undermining both society and individual self-worth.

2.Question

How does David Ogilvy defend the role of advertising in society?

Answer:Ogilvy asserts that advertising is a necessary and efficient means of selling products. He emphasizes that it can have positive effects, such as encouraging good hygiene through dental care advertising, or supporting the economy of regions, like Puerto Rico.

3.Question

What is Ogilvy's perspective on the ethical implications of advertising?

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Answer:He believes that the morality of advertising depends largely on what is being advertised. While acknowledging that some practitioners might stray, he emphasizes that legitimate advertising serves the consumer's interests and can enhance their lives.

4.Question

What comparison does Ogilvy make between advertising and other forms of communication?

Answer:He likens advertising to the printing press, stating that just as it can produce both pornography and the Bible, advertising can promote both good and bad products, depending on the intent behind it.

5.Question

How does Ogilvy respond to the notion that advertising manipulates consumers?

Answer:He cites the lack of evidence that advertising manipulates through subliminal messaging and argues that any manipulation is heavily regulated. He stresses that consumers are well aware of what they want.

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6.Question

Why does Ogilvy claim that political advertising is worse than commercial advertising?

Answer:He argues that political commercials are often dishonest and unregulated, allowing manipulation and deceit without the scrutiny faced by product advertisements. He believes this discrepancy is a grave issue within democracy.

7.Question

According to Ogilvy, what is the impact of billboards on public safety and aesthetics?

Answer:He points out that areas with billboards have higher accident rates and that billboards are damaging to public scenery rather than beneficial, arguing that few have any business in promoting them.

8.Question

What does Ogilvy suggest about the necessity of advertising for the sale of inferior products?

Answer:He suggests that while advertising can sell inferior products initially, customers will not return if the product proves to be substandard, which ultimately harms the

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manufacturer financially.

9.Question

What is Ogilvy's view on the amount of information provided in advertisements?

Answer:He believes that most advertisements fall short of providing necessary information that consumers need to make informed decisions, advocating for more factual and detailed advertising.

10.Question

What overall conclusion does Ogilvy draw about the nature of advertising?

Answer:He believes that advertising can be both beneficial and detrimental, and its value lies in how it is used. Ultimately, it serves a vital function in the economy, being a tool that reflects both the virtues and vices of the marketplace.

Chapter 20 | 20. I predict 13 changes| Q&A

1.Question

What future change does Ogilvy predict will improve the effectiveness of advertising?

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Answer:Ogilvy predicts that the quality of research will improve, leading to a greater understanding of what works and what doesn't in advertising. This enhancement will enable creative professionals to utilize this knowledge better, resulting in higher success rates in generating revenue.

2.Question

Will print advertising see a revival?

Answer:Yes, Ogilvy anticipates a renaissance in print advertising, suggesting a resurgence in its relevance and effectiveness in the advertising landscape.

3.Question

What is the expected shift in the information content of advertisements?

Answer:Advertising will feature more information and less 'hot air', indicating a move towards more substantial, informative content that genuinely communicates value to consumers.

4.Question

What does Ogilvy predict will happen to billboards in the

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future?

Answer:Ogilvy predicts that billboards will be abolished, indicating a significant change in how outdoor advertising is approached.

5.Question

How does Ogilvy foresee the regulation of commercial clutter?

Answer:Ogilvy believes that the clutter of commercials on television and radio will be controlled, reflecting a shift towards more focused and less overwhelming advertising experiences for audiences.

6.Question

In what area will governments significantly increase their advertising efforts?

Answer:Governments will significantly increase advertising efforts for educational purposes, particularly in health education, reflecting a societal push for awareness and public health initiatives.

7.Question

What role will advertising play regarding the population

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explosion?

Answer:Advertising is expected to contribute to controlling the population explosion, implying a broader societal and ethical responsibility in the messaging and information disseminated.

8.Question

How does Ogilvy view the future of political advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy expects that candidates for political office will stop using dishonest advertising, which suggests a future trend towards more ethical campaigning.

9.Question

What trend does Ogilvy predict for international advertising quality?

Answer:Ogilvy predicts continuous improvement in the quality and efficiency of advertising overseas, implying that foreign markets will increasingly outperform American advertising standards.

10.Question

Will foreign advertising agencies enter the US market?

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Answer:Yes, Ogilvy predicts that several foreign agencies will open offices in the United States and will prosper, indicating a growing interconnection in the global advertising landscape.

11.Question

What impact will multinational manufacturers have on advertising?

Answer:Multinational manufacturers are expected to increase their market shares globally and adapt their advertising campaigns to respect local cultural differences, leading to a more tailored advertising approach.

12.Question

How does Ogilvy see the future of direct-response advertising?

Answer:Ogilvy believes that direct-response advertising will cease to be a separate specialty and will be integrated into general advertising agencies, suggesting a blending of techniques and strategies.

13.Question

What does Ogilvy predict regarding the cost of television

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commercials?

Answer:Ogilvy envisions that methods will be discovered to produce effective television commercials at more sensible costs, indicating a push for efficiency in advertising expenditures.

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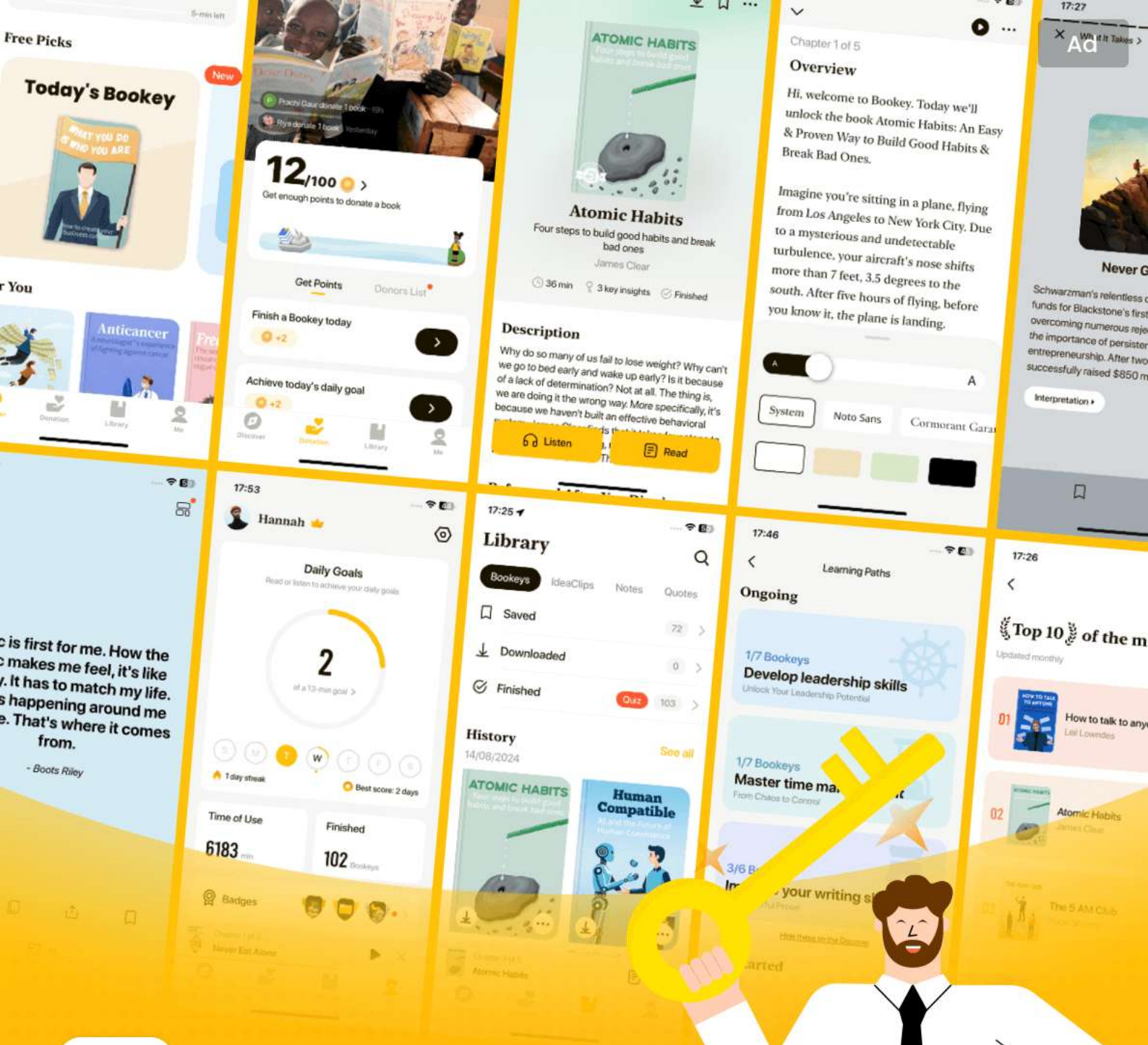

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Ogilvy on Advertising Quiz and Test

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Chapter 1 | 1. Overture| Quiz and Test

1. David Ogilvy believes that advertising is primarily an artistic endeavor rather than a medium of information.
2. Ogilvy claims that despite changes in the advertising landscape, many fundamental advertising principles still remain valid.
3. Ogilvy criticizes established advertising techniques as being obsolete and ineffective in today's market.

Chapter 2 | 2. How to produce advertising that sells| Quiz and Test

1. Successful advertising begins with thorough homework about the product and the market.
2. Ogilvy believes that ads should focus primarily on creativity rather than sales results.
3. A strong brand image is essential for product identity and influences consumer preferences.

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Chapter 3 | 3. Jobs in advertising – and how to get them| Quiz and Test

1. Copywriters in advertising can be categorized into poets, who view ads as art, and killers, who focus on effectiveness.
2. Art Directors in advertising roles do not require any specialized training in areas like film or photography.
3. Many advertising agencies now prefer candidates for entry-level positions to have backgrounds in sciences rather than liberal arts.

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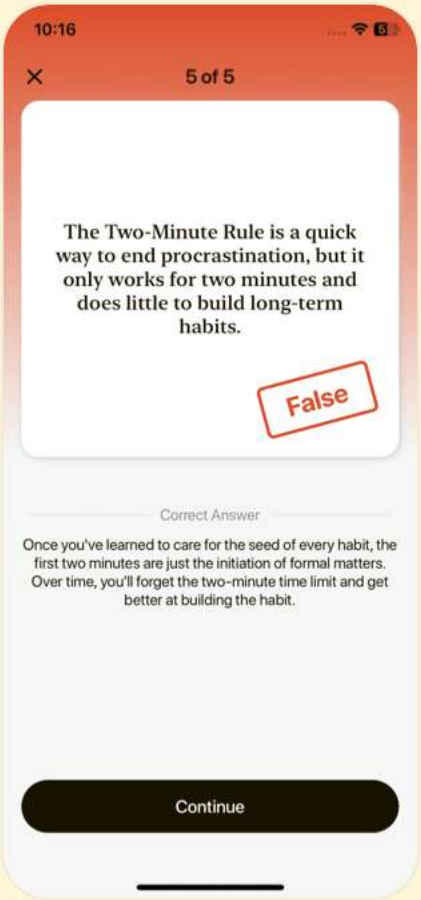

Chapter 4 | 4. How to run an advertising agency| Quiz and Test

1. Running an advertising agency does not require strong leadership.
2. Leaders in advertising agencies should possess enthusiasm and effective communication skills.
3. Most agency employees are involved in creating advertisements.

Chapter 5 | 5. How to get clients| Quiz and Test

1. David Ogilvy believes that the best way to gain clients is to produce exceptional advertising work.
2. Ogilvy suggests that small agencies often lack creativity and personalized service compared to larger agencies.
3. Ogilvy emphasizes the importance of consistency and clarity in messaging for house advertisements to resonate with prospective clients.

Chapter 6 | 6. Open letter to a client in search of an agency| Quiz and Test

1. A committee should be delegated to select a client agency instead of personal involvement.

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2.It is unnecessary to meet with the heads and Creative Directors of shortlisted agencies.

3.A client should insist on a five-year contract to ensure stability in their partnership with the agency.

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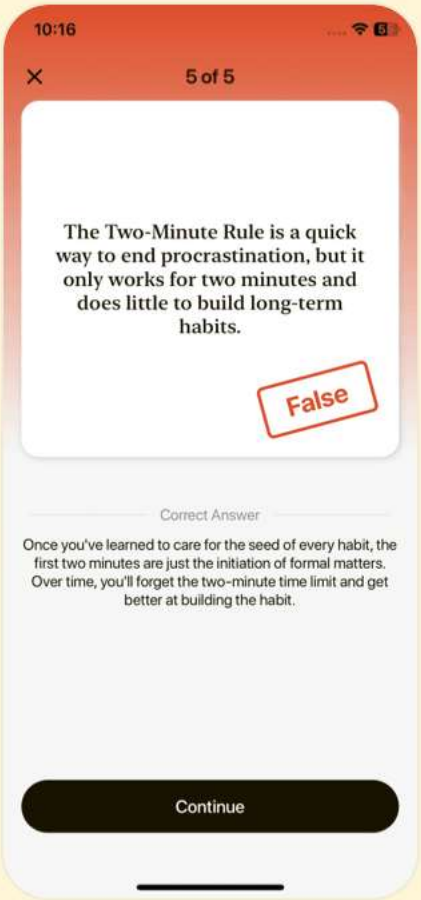

Chapter 7 | 7. Wanted: a renaissance in print advertising| Quiz and Test

1. According to David Ogilvy, headlines significantly influence ad performance, being read five times more than body copy.
2. Ogilvy suggests that complicated or vague headlines can be more effective than clear and direct ones.
3. Ogilvy believes that celebrity endorsements in advertisements always increase credibility and should be included in every ad.

Chapter 8 | 8. How to make TV commercials that sell| Quiz and Test

1. Celebrity testimonials are effective in shifting brand preferences according to Ogilvy.
2. Using humor in commercials can be an effective way to sell products as per recent research discussed by Ogilvy.
3. Ogilvy suggests that showing the product package at the end of a commercial is an important strategy for effectiveness.

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Chapter 9 | 9. Advertising corporations| Quiz and Test

1. Corporate advertising primarily focuses on promoting the corporation itself rather than just its products.
2. Most corporate advertising campaigns successfully achieve their objectives without a long-term commitment.
3. Underfunding corporate advertising compared to product promotion is a common issue among companies.

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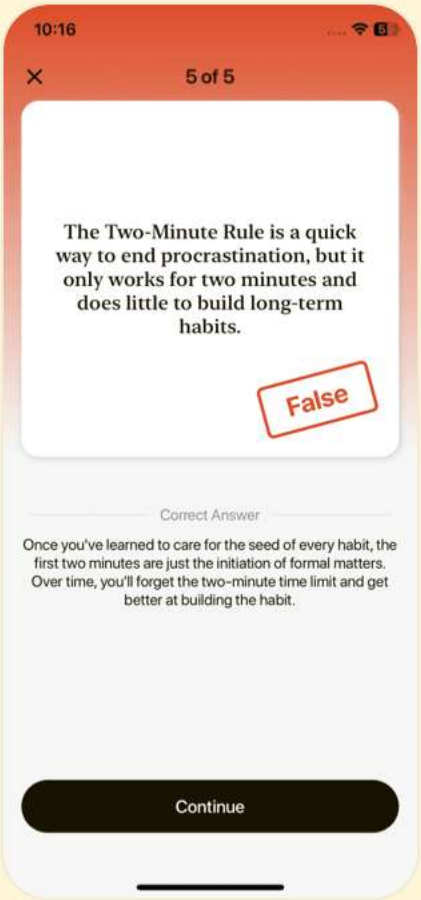

Chapter 10 | 10. How to advertise foreign travel| Quiz and Test

1. American tourists prefer historical sights in Britain according to Ogilvy's research.
2. Ogilvy believes that effective tourism advertising does not need to consider the unique elements of a country.
3. Television advertising is more effective than print media for tourism according to Ogilvy.

Chapter 11 | 11. The secrets of success in business-to-business advertising| Quiz and Test

1. Business-to-business (B2B) advertising aims to promote products purchased for individual consumption rather than for company use.
2. Television is not a suitable medium for B2B advertising due to its cost and ineffectiveness.
3. Using clear and specific promises in B2B advertising can enhance the effectiveness of the advertisement.

Chapter 12 | 12. Direct mail, my first love and secret weapon| Quiz and Test

1. David Ogilvy regards direct mail as an

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appreciated marketing tool. Is this true or false?

2. Advancements in computer technology have helped direct mail evolve by allowing for more precise demographic targeting. Is this true or false?

3. According to Ogilvy, long letters are ineffective in driving sales. Is this true or false?

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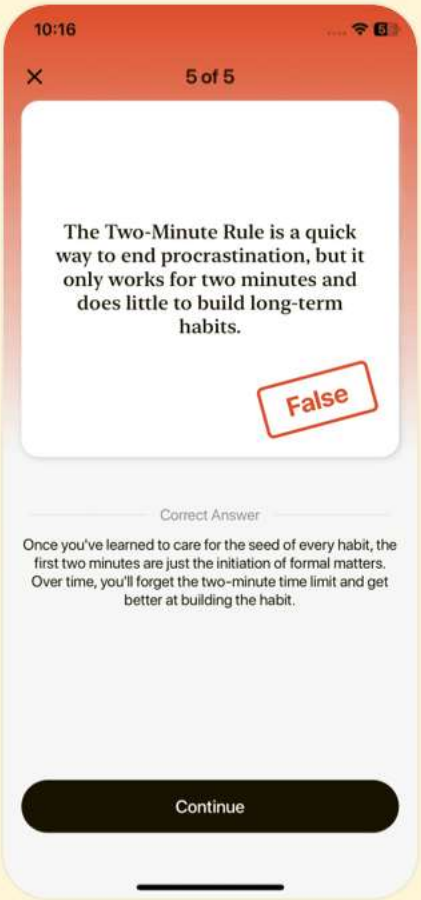

Chapter 13 | 13. Advertising for good causes| Quiz and Test

1. The Advertising Council was established by the advertising industry in the United States to create free campaigns for various charitable causes.
2. In 1979, media outlets provided $1 billion worth of free space and time for charity campaigns in the United States.
3. Ogilvy suggests that advertisements can directly generate enough contributions to cover advertising costs for charitable causes.

Chapter 14 | 14. Competing with Procter & Gamble| Quiz and Test

1. Procter & Gamble has a market share of at least 40% in several categories including disposable diapers, fabric softeners, and cleansers.
2. P&G's advertising strategies include launching a single brand in each product category to minimize competition.
3. P&G does not utilize consumer insight and market research to inform their advertising strategies.

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Chapter 15 | 15. 18 Miracles of research| Quiz and Test

1. David Ogilvy states that research is as crucial in advertising as it is in military strategy.
2. According to Ogilvy, research can predict long-term brand contributions and determine product pricing.
3. Ogilvy believes that research lacks any role in enhancing the creativity of advertising campaigns.

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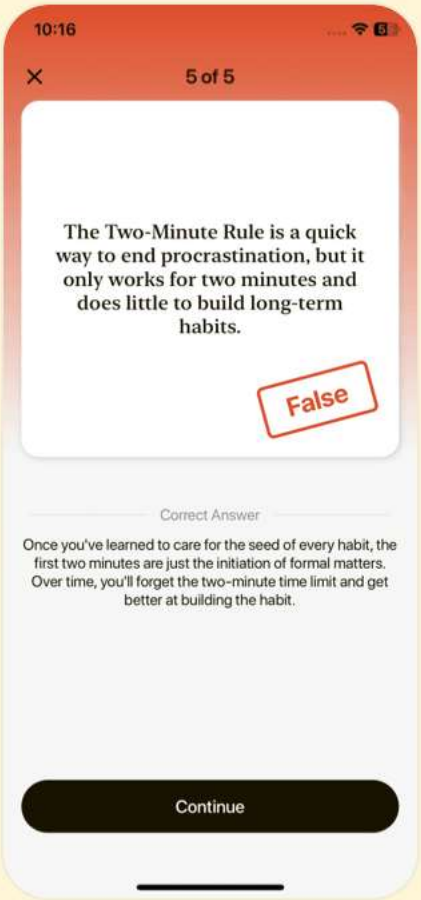

Chapter 16 | 16. What little I know about marketing| Quiz and Test

1. Eight out of ten new consumer products fail due to lack of differentiation or being inadequately innovative.
2. The traditional 'blockbuster brand' approach is the most effective strategy for marketing in today's niche market landscape.
3. Ogilvy believes that excessive focus on promotions can create lasting brand loyalty.

Chapter 17 | 17. Is America still top nation?| Quiz and Test

1. The United States accounts for approximately half of all global advertising, with American agencies leading in many countries.
2. British ads are generally more direct and competitive than American ads.
3. Communist nations do not engage in advertising for consumer goods.

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Chapter 18 | 18. Lasker, Resor, Rubicam, Burnett, Hopkins and Bernbach| Quiz and Test

1. Albert Lasker believed that compelling content was more important than the visual aspects of advertising.
2. Stanley Resor successfully modernized his approaches throughout his career, leading to significant growth without challenges.
3. Bill Bernbach was known for prioritizing traditional research methods over creativity in advertising.

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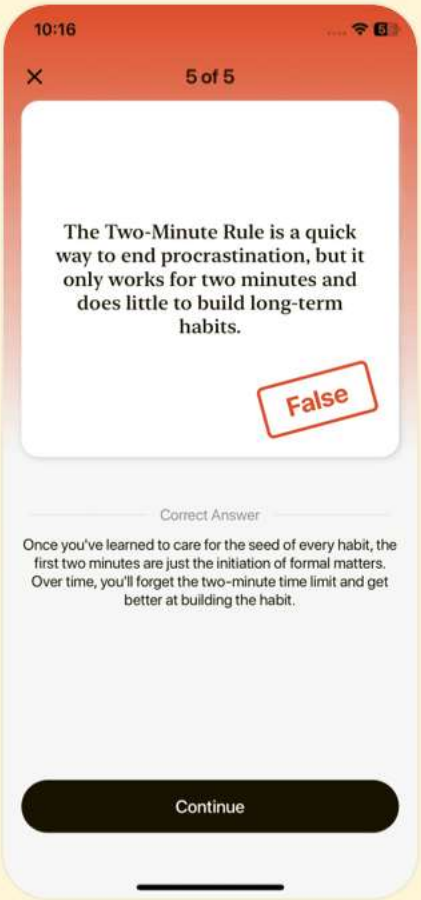

Chapter 19 | 19. What’s wrong with advertising?| Quiz and Test

1. Economists may see advertising as an economic waste, but manufacturers view it as vital.
2. Aside from deceptive political advertising, truth in advertising has improved significantly.
3. Eliminating billboards would enhance public spaces.

Chapter 20 | 20. I predict 13 changes| Quiz and Test

1. David Ogilvy predicts that print advertising will experience a revival.
2. Ogilvy believes that billboards will be abolished from the advertising landscape.
3. Ogilvy predicts that political candidates will continue to rely on dishonest advertising practices.

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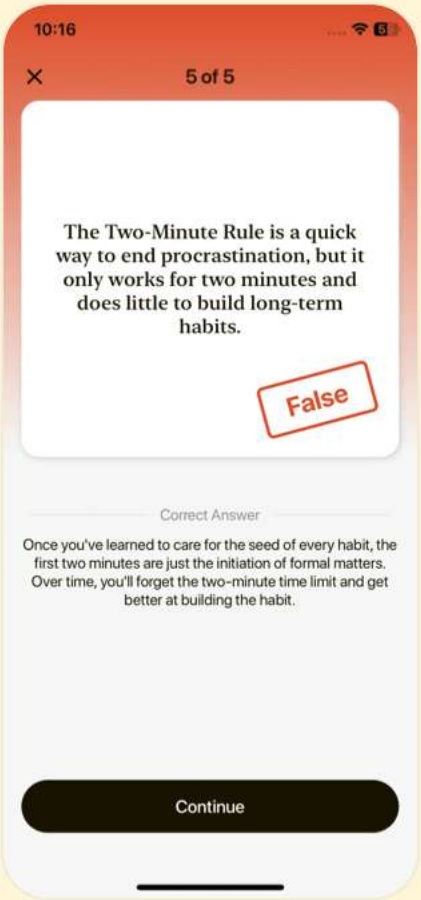
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